

Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve

SEACAR Habitat Analyses

Last compiled on 10 June, 2026

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Funding & Acknowledgements

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Threshold Filtering

Threshold filters, following the guidance of Florida Department of Environmental Protection's (*FDEP*) Division of Environmental Assessment and Restoration (*DEAR*) are used to exclude specific results values from the SEACAR Analysis. Based on the threshold filters, Quality Assurance / Quality Control (*QAQC*) Flags are inserted into the *SEACAR_QAQCFlagCode* and *SEACAR_QAQC_Description* columns of the export data. The *Include* column indicates whether the *QAQC* Flag will also indicate that data are excluded from analysis. No data are excluded from the data export, but the analysis scripts can use the *Include* column to exclude data (1 to include, 0 to exclude).

Table 1: Continuous Water Quality threshold values

<i>Parameter Name</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Low Threshold</i>	<i>High Threshold</i>
Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	-0.000001	50
Dissolved Oxygen Saturation	%	-0.000001	500
Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter	QSE	-	-
Salinity	ppt	-0.000001	70
Specific Conductivity	mS/cm	-0.000001	200
Turbidity	NTU	-0.000001	4000
Water Temperature	Degrees C	-5.000000	45
pH	None	2.000000	14

Table 2: Discrete Water Quality threshold values

<i>Parameter Name</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Low Threshold</i>	<i>High Threshold</i>
Ammonia, Un-ionized (NH3)	mg/L	-	-
Ammonium (NH4)	mg/L	-	-

<i>Parameter Name</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Low Threshold</i>	<i>High Threshold</i>
Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin	ug/L	-	-
Colored Dissolved Organic Matter	PCU	-	-
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	-0.000001	25
Dissolved Oxygen Saturation	%	-0.000001	310
Fluorescent Dissolved Organic Matter	QSE	-	-
Light Extinction Coefficient	m ⁻¹	-	-
NO2+3, Filtered	mg/L	-	-
Nitrate (NO3)	mg/L	-	-
Nitrite (NO2)	mg/L	-	-
Nitrogen, inorganic	mg/L	-	-
Nitrogen, organic	mg/L	-	-
Phosphate, Filtered (PO4)	mg/L	-	-
Salinity	ppt	-0.000001	70
Secchi Depth	m	0.000001	50
Specific Conductivity	mS/cm	0.005000	100
Total Ammonia (N)	mg/L	-	-
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	-	-
Total Phosphorus	mg/L	-	-
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	-	-
Turbidity	NTU	-	-
Water Temperature	Degrees C	3.000000	40
pH	None	2.000000	13

Table 3: Quality Assurance Flags inserted based on threshold checks listed in Table 1 and 2

<i>SEACAR QAQC Description</i>	<i>Include</i>	<i>SEACAR QAQCFlagCode</i>
Exceeds maximum threshold	0	2Q
Below minimum threshold	0	4Q
Within threshold tolerance	1	6Q
No defined thresholds for this parameter	1	7Q

Value Qualifiers

Value qualifier codes included within the data are used to exclude certain results from the analysis. The data are retained in the data export files, but the analysis uses the *Include* column to filter the results.

STORET and WIN value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from *STORET* and *WIN* data are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports.

Table 4: Value Qualifier codes excluded from analysis

<i>Qualifier Source</i>	<i>Value Qualifier</i>	<i>Include</i>	<i>MDL</i>	<i>Description</i>
STORET-WIN	H	0	0	Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate
STORET-WIN	J	0	0	Estimated value
STORET-WIN	V	0	0	Analyte was detected at or above method detection limit
STORET-WIN	Y	0	0	Lab analysis from an improperly preserved sample; data may be inaccurate

Discrete Water Quality Value Qualifiers

The following value qualifiers are highlighted in the Discrete Water Quality section of this report. An exception is made for **Program 476** - *Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network* and data flagged with Value Qualifier **H** are included for this program only.

H - Value based on field kit determination; results may not be accurate. This code shall be used if a field screening test (e.g., field gas chromatograph data, immunoassay, or vendor-supplied field kit) was used to generate the value and the field kit or method has not been recognized by the Department as equivalent to laboratory methods.

I - The reported value is greater than or equal to the laboratory method detection limit but less than the laboratory practical quantitation limit.

Q - Sample held beyond the accepted holding time. This code shall be used if the value is derived from a sample that was prepared or analyzed after the approved holding time restrictions for sample preparation or analysis.

S - Secchi disk visible to bottom of waterbody. The value reported is the depth of the waterbody at the location of the Secchi disk measurement.

U - Indicates that the compound was analyzed for but not detected. This symbol shall be used to indicate that the specified component was not detected. The value associated with the qualifier shall be the laboratory method detection limit. Unless requested by the client, less than the method detection limit values shall not be reported

Systemwide Monitoring Program (SWMP) value qualifier codes

Value qualifier codes from the *SWMP* continuous program are examined with the database and used to populate the *Include* column in data exports. *SWMP* Qualifier Codes are indicated by *QualifierSource=SWMP*.

Table 5: SWMP Value Qualifier codes

<i>Qualifier Source</i>	<i>Value Qualifier</i>	<i>Include</i>	<i>Description</i>
SWMP	-1	1	Optional parameter not collected
SWMP	-2	0	Missing data
SWMP	-3	0	Data rejected due to QA/QC
SWMP	-4	0	Outside low sensor range
SWMP	-5	0	Outside high sensor range
SWMP	0	1	Passed initial QA/QC checks
SWMP	1	0	Suspect data
SWMP	2	1	Reserved for future use
SWMP	3	1	Calculated data: non-vented depth/level sensor correction for changes in barometric pressure
SWMP	4	1	Historical: Pre-auto QA/QC
SWMP	5	1	Corrected data

Water Column

The water column habitat extends from the water's surface to the bottom sediments, and it's where fish, dolphins, crabs and people swim! So much life makes its home in the water column that the health of marine and coastal ecosystems, as well as human economies, depend on the condition of this vulnerable habitat. Local patterns of rainfall, temperature, winds and currents can rapidly change the condition of the water column, while global influences such as [El Niño/La Niña](#), large-scale fluctuation in sea temperatures and climate change can have long-term effects. Inputs from the prosperity of our day-to-day lives including farming, mining and forestry, and emissions from power generation, automobiles and water treatment can also alter the health of the water column. Acting alone or together, each input can have complex and lasting effects on habitats and ecosystems.

SEACAR evaluates water column health with several essential parameters. These include nutrient surveys of nitrogen and phosphorus, and water quality assessments of salinity, dissolved oxygen, pH, and water temperature. Water clarity is evaluated with Secchi depth, turbidity, levels of chlorophyll a, total suspended solids, and colored dissolved organic matter. Additionally, the richness of nekton is indicated by the abundance of free-swimming fishes and macroinvertebrates like crabs and shrimps.

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Analysis

Indicators must have a minimum of five to ten years, depending on the habitat, of data within the geographic range of the analysis to be included in the analysis. Ten years of data are required for discrete parameters, and five years of data are required for continuous parameters. If there are insufficient years of data, the number of years of data available will be noted and labeled as "insufficient data to conduct analysis". Further, for the preferred Seasonal Kendall-Tau test, there must be data from at least two months in common across at least two consecutive years within the RCP managed area being analyzed. Values that pass both of these tests will be included in the analysis and be labeled as *Use_In_Analysis* = **TRUE**. Any that fail either test will be excluded from the analyses and labeled as *Use_In_Analysis* = **FALSE**. The points for all Water Column plots displayed in this section are monthly averages. Trend significance will be denoted as "Significant Trend" (when $p < 0.05$), or "Non-significant Trend" (when $p \geq 0.05$). Any parameters with insufficient data to perform Seasonal Kendall-Tau test will have their monthly averages plotted without a corresponding trend line.

Water Quality - Discrete

The following files were used in the discrete analysis:

- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Chlorophyll_a_corrected_for_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Chlorophyll_a_uncorrected_for_pheophytin-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Colored_dissolved_organic_matter_CDOM-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Dissolved_Oxygen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Dissolved_Oxygen_Saturation-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_pH-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Salinity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Secchi_Depth-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Nitrogen-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Phosphorus-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Total_Suspended_Solids_TSS-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Turbidity-2026-May-18.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_Water_Temperature-2026-May-18.txt*

Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

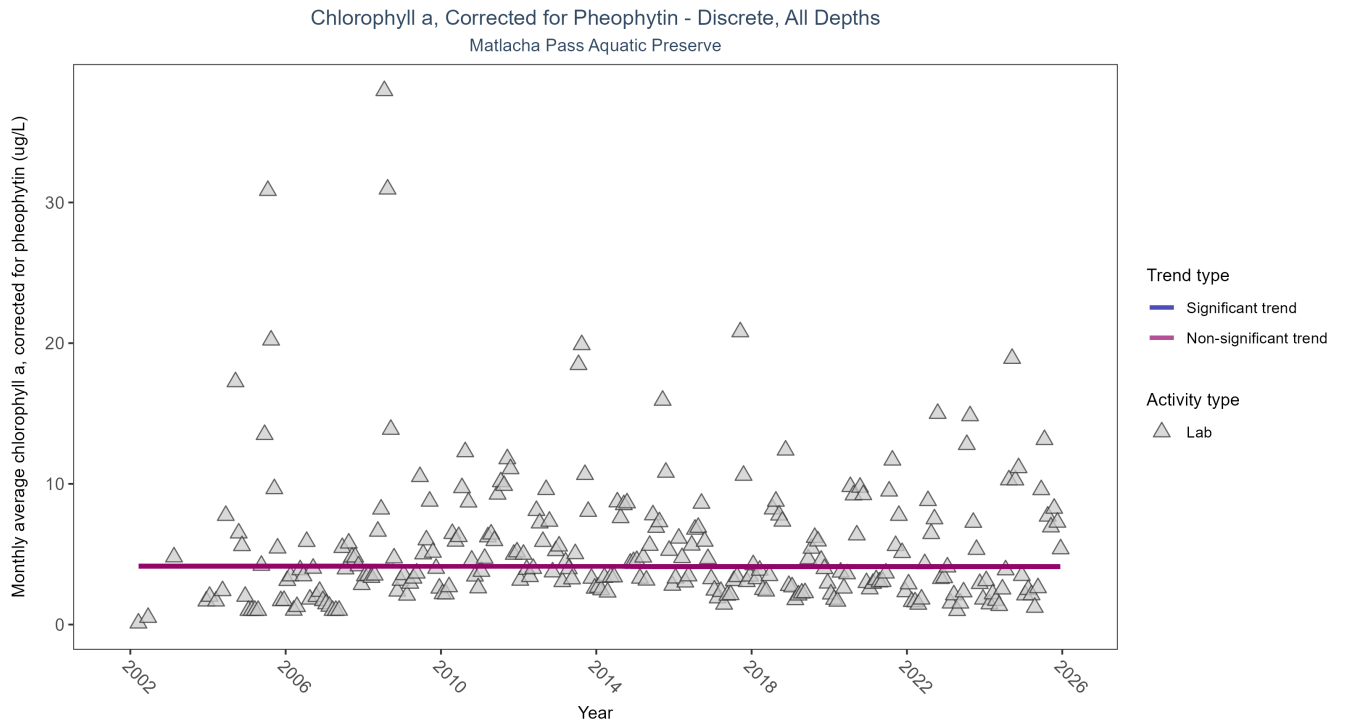


Figure 1: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 6: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	No detectable trend	2014	24	2002 - 2025	3.4	-0.0069	4.152	-0.0017	0.9094

Chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, showed no detectable trend between 2002 and 2025.

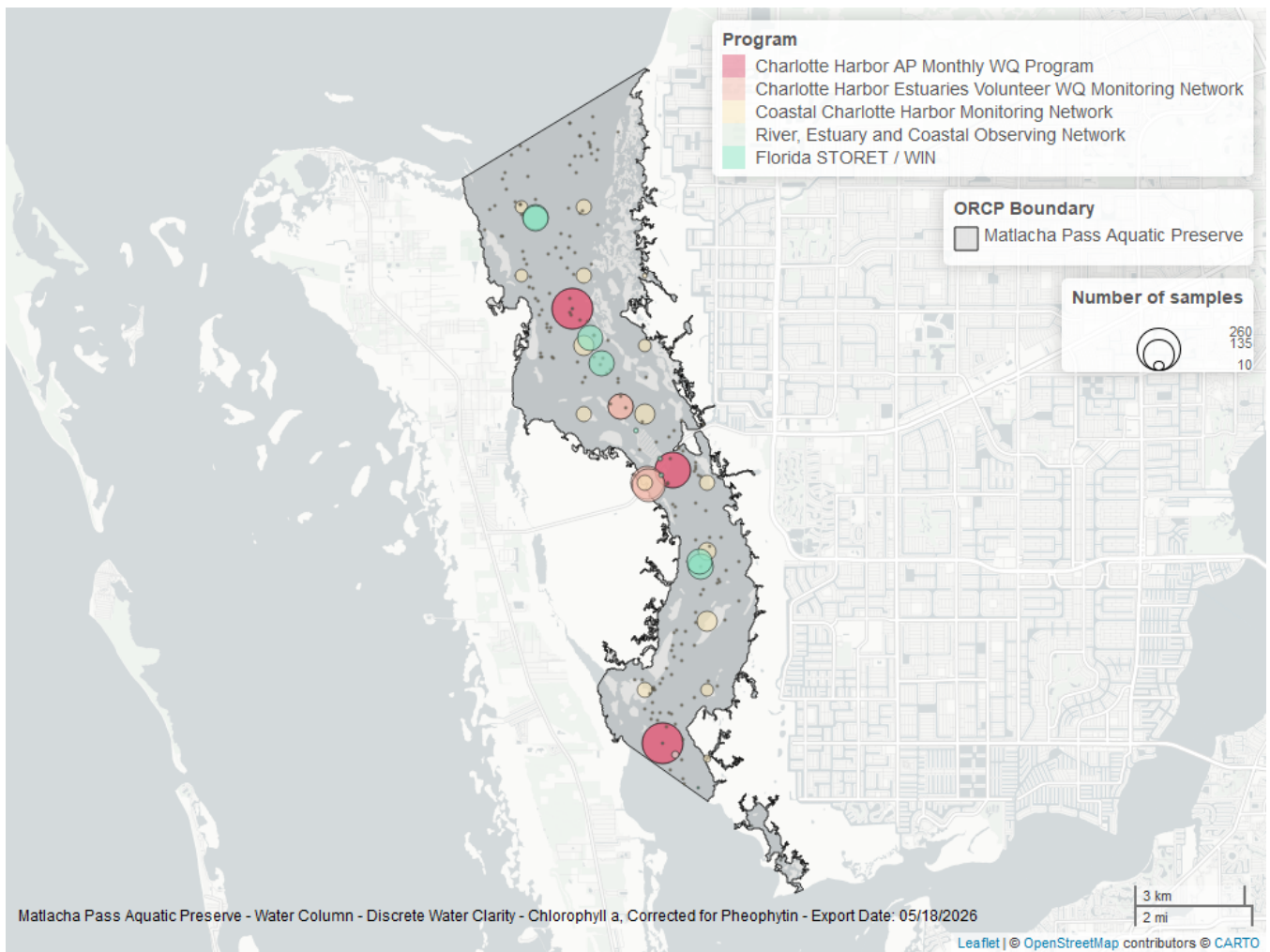


Figure 2: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 7: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
513	758	2002	2025
5028	704	2007	2025
5002	291	2005	2025
476	268	2008	2025
303	9	2019	2025

Program names:

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵

Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

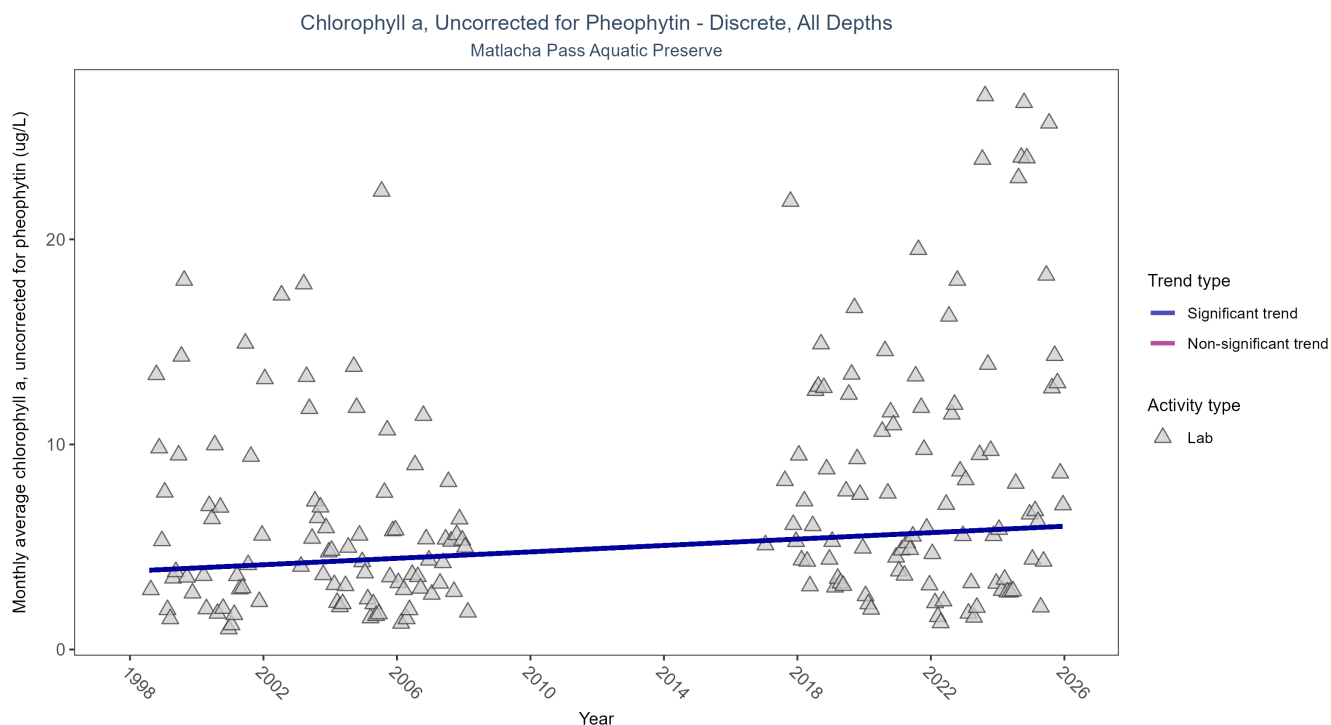


Figure 3: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 8: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Increasing trend	576	20	1998 - 2025	4.935	0.2006	3.8209	0.0782	0.0001

Monthly average chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, increased by 0.08 $\mu\text{g/L}$ per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

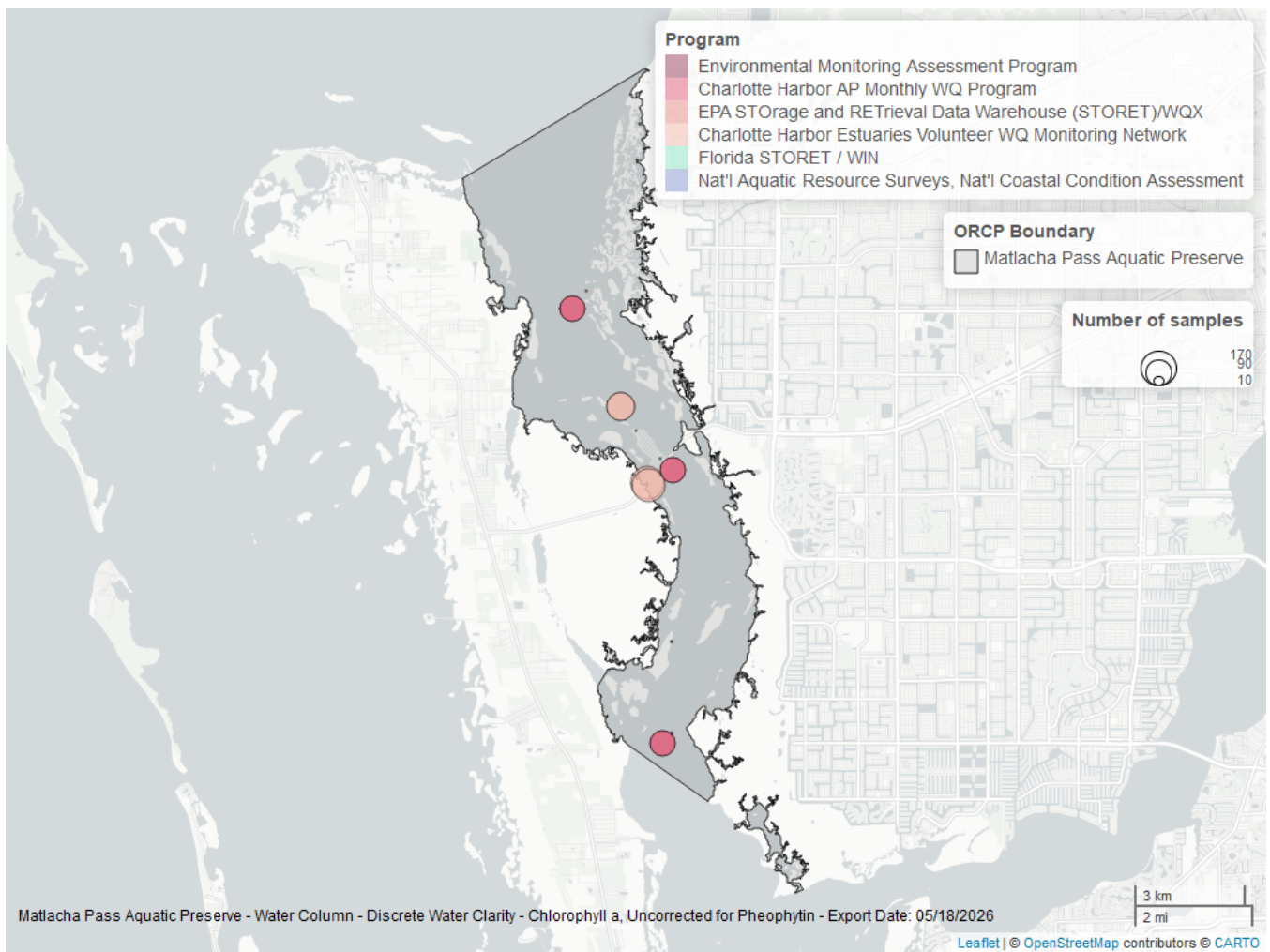


Figure 4: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 9: Programs contributing data for Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5028	293	2017	2025
476	288	1998	2025
5002	6	2005	2005
103	3	2001	2005
118	2	2001	2005
115	1	2001	2001

Program names:

[5028](#) - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²

[476](#) - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶

118 - National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment⁷

115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁸

Dissolved Oxygen - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

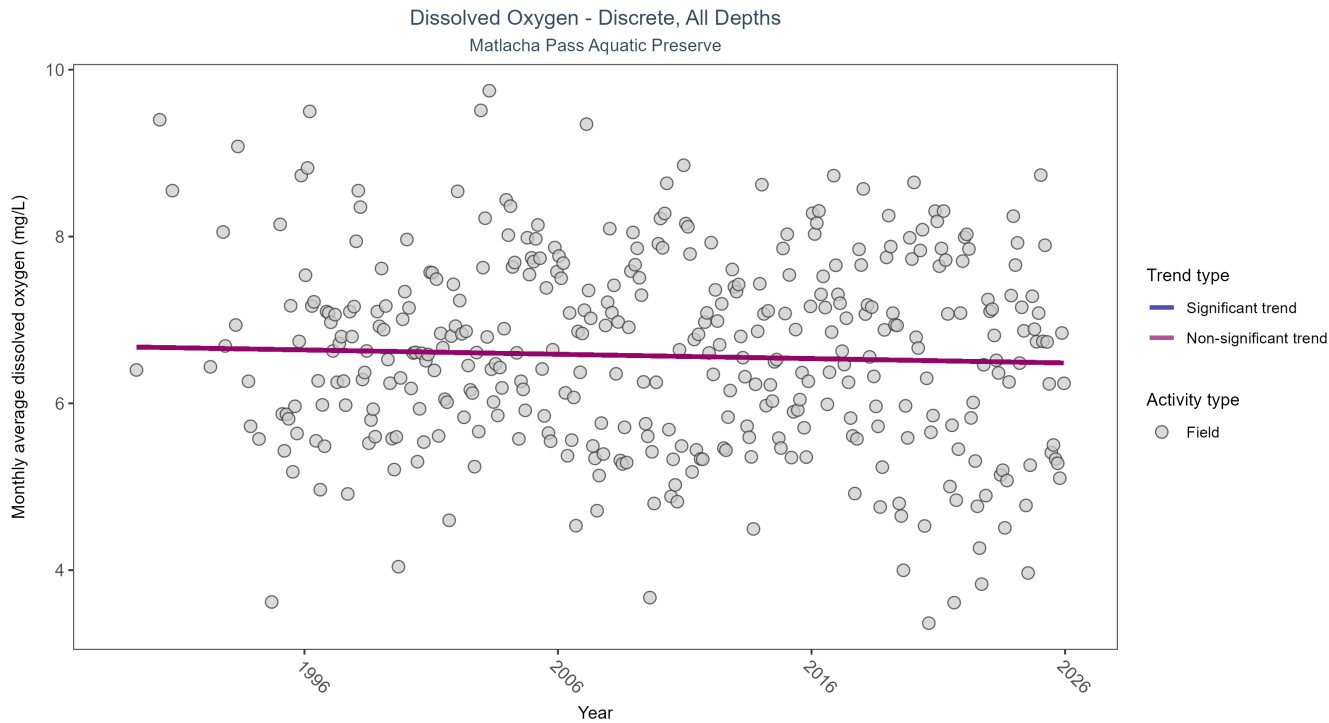


Figure 5: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 10: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	No detectable trend	11886	36	1989 - 2025	6.59	-0.0425	6.6766	-0.0052	0.2411

Dissolved oxygen showed no detectable trend between 1989 and 2025.

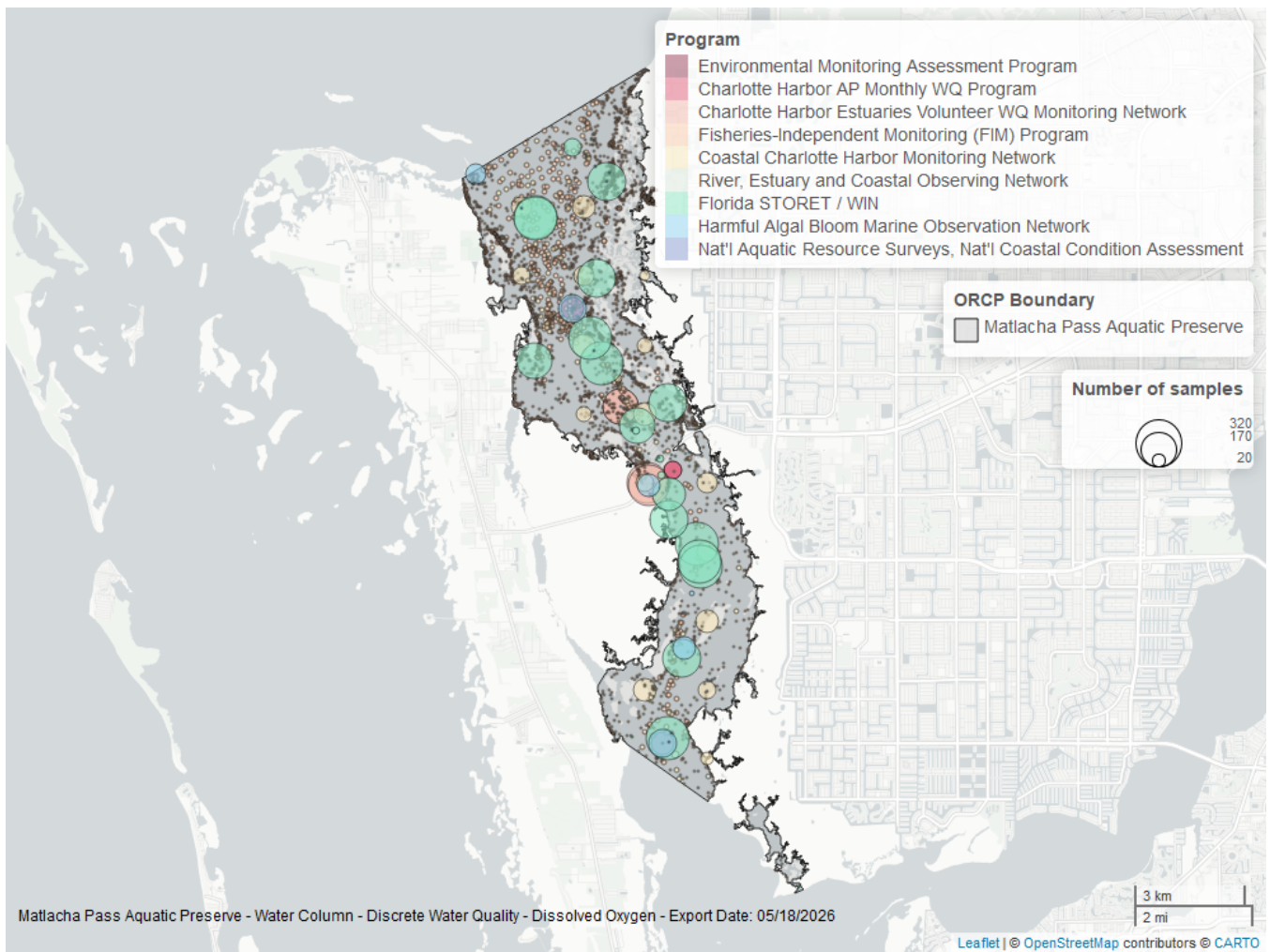


Figure 6: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 11: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	5860	1989	2024
5002	3182	1995	2025
513	1679	2002	2025
95	499	1996	2018
476	468	1998	2025
5028	197	2007	2025
303	64	2018	2025
115	5	2001	2001
118	2	2001	2005

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program⁹

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹⁰

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴
 5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²
 303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁸
 118 - National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment⁷

Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

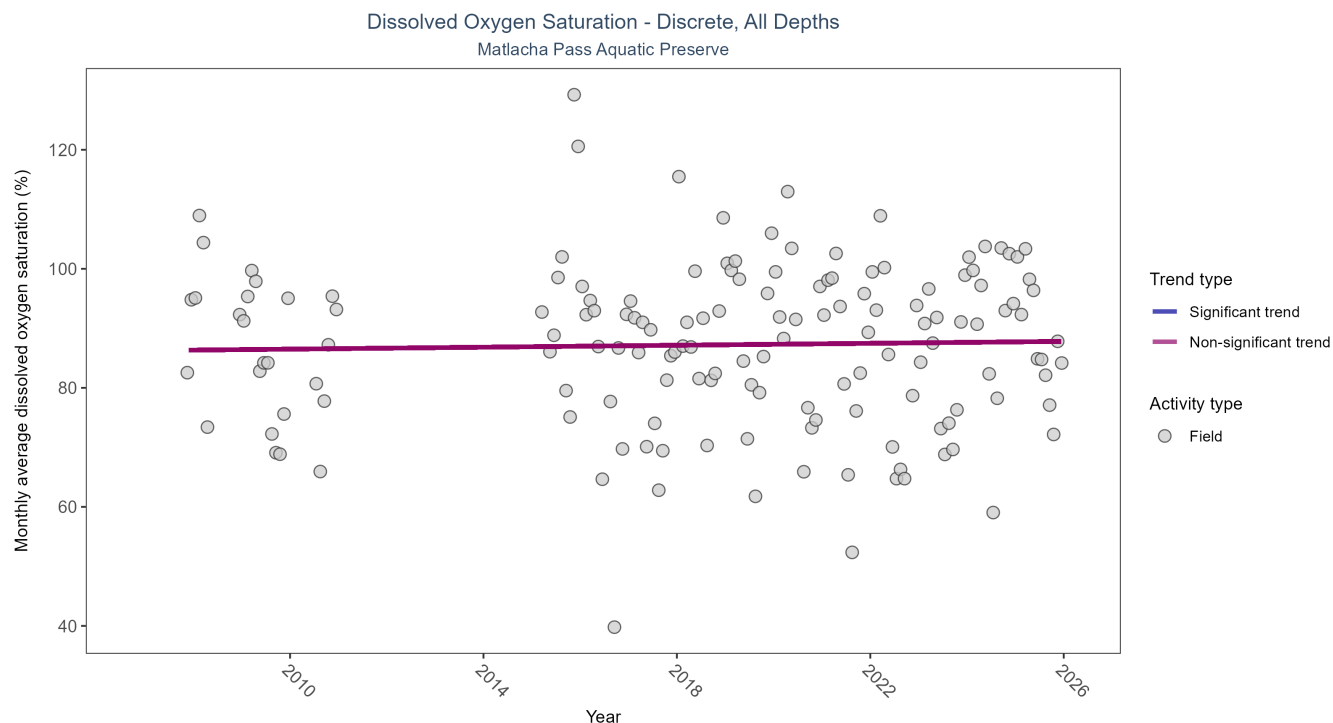


Figure 7: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen saturation values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 12: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	No detectable trend	1464	15	2007 - 2025	89.8071	0.0468	86.2597	0.0813	0.4532

Dissolved oxygen saturation showed no detectable trend between 2007 and 2025.

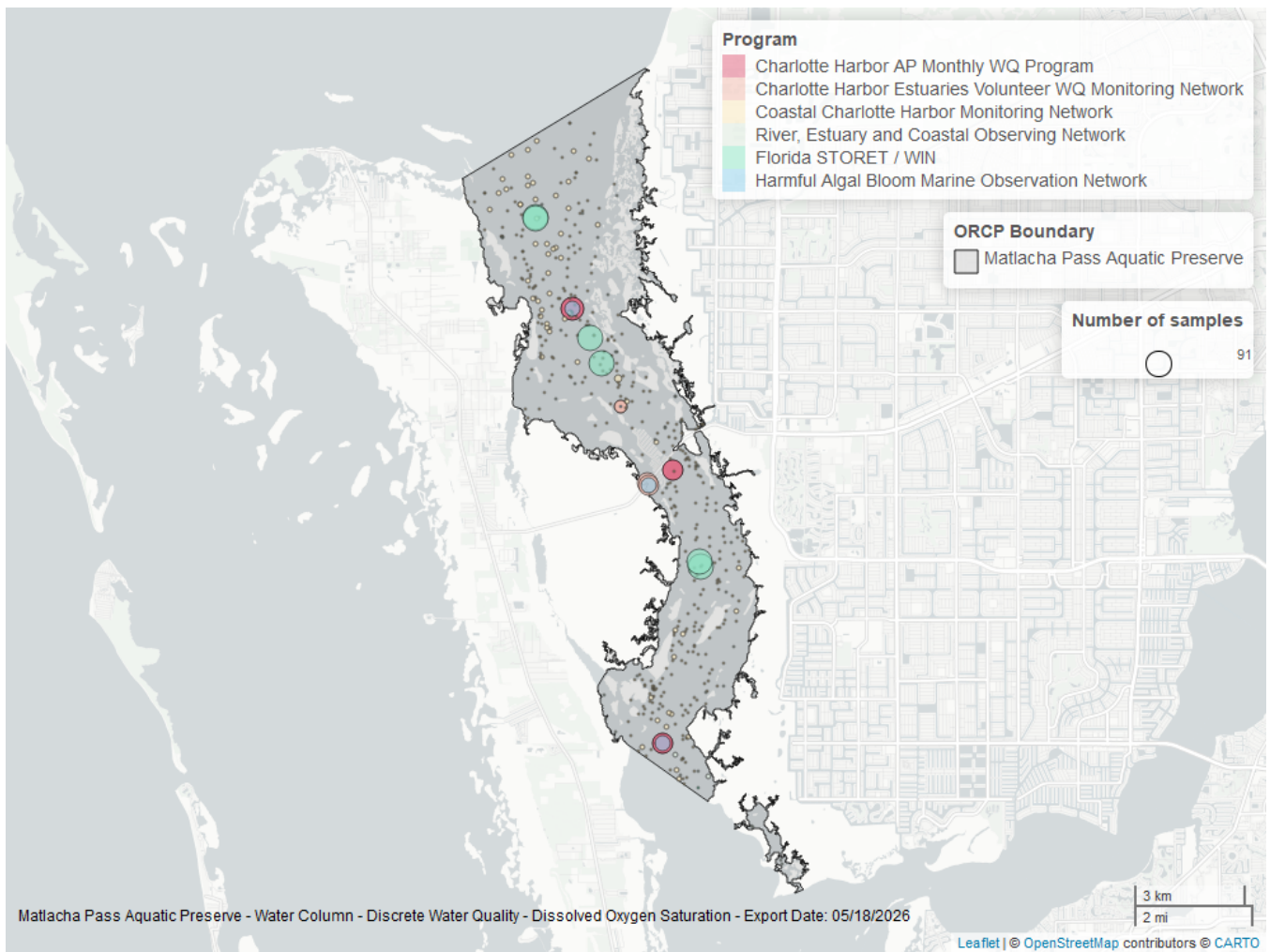


Figure 8: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 13: Programs contributing data for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
513	737	2017	2025
5002	274	2018	2025
5028	204	2007	2025
95	120	2008	2018
476	86	2017	2025
303	60	2019	2025

Program names:

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹⁰

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵

pH - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

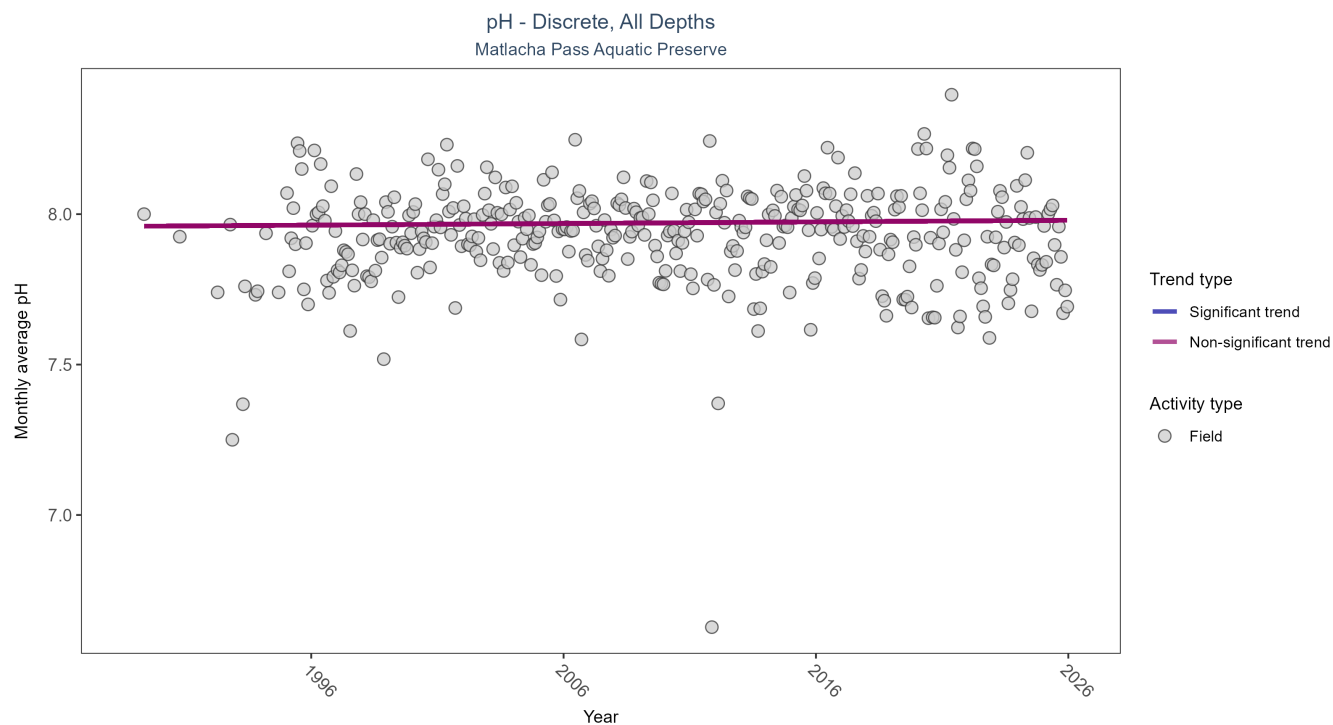


Figure 9: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only pH values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 14: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for pH

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	No detectable trend	11229	36	1989 - 2025	7.93	0.0177	7.9597	0.0005	0.5593

pH showed no detectable trend between 1989 and 2025.

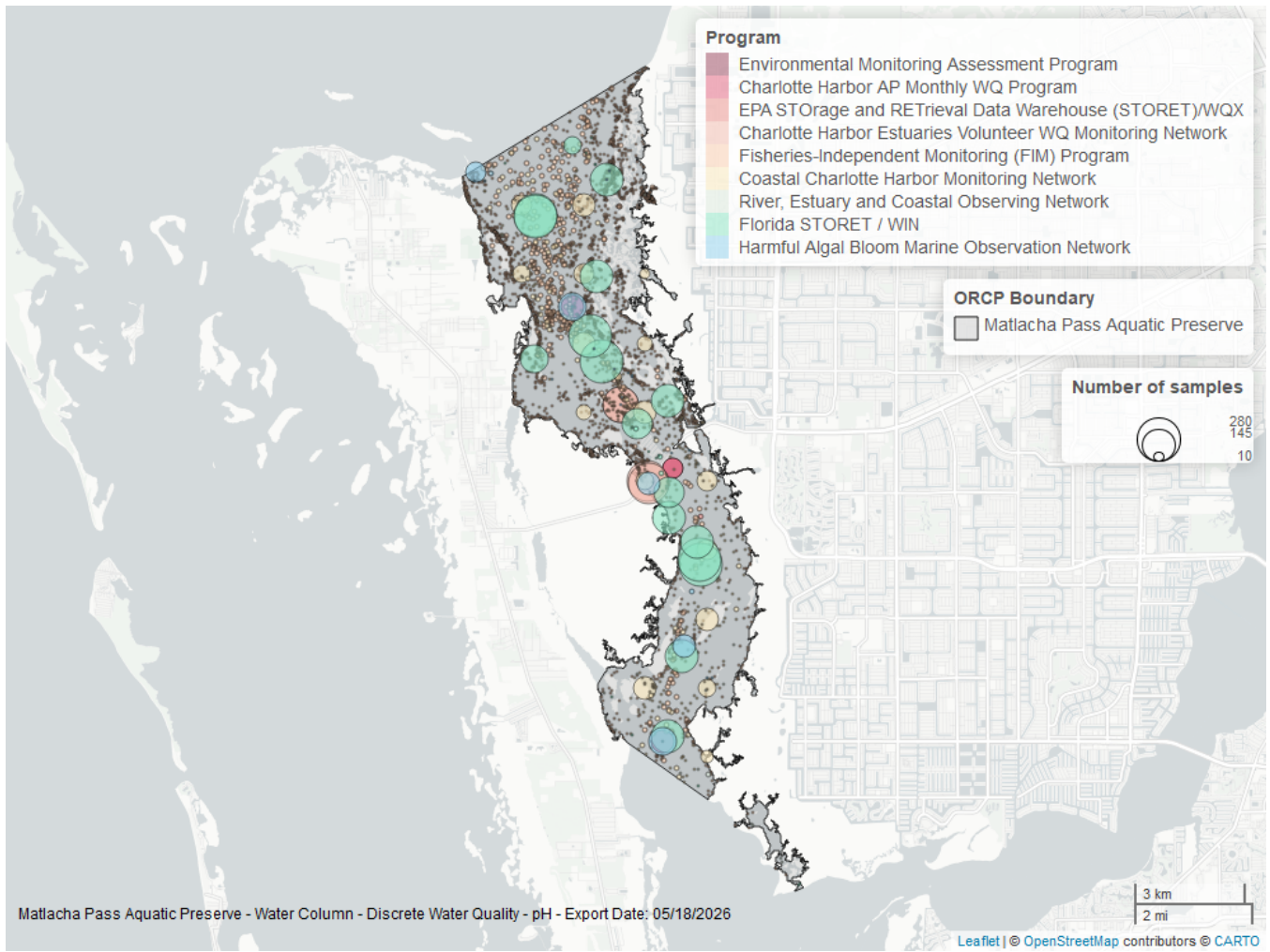


Figure 10: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 15: Programs contributing data for pH

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	5797	1989	2024
5002	2500	1995	2025
513	1675	2002	2025
95	501	1996	2018
476	471	1998	2025
5028	244	2007	2025
303	47	2024	2025
115	5	2001	2001
103	5	2004	2005

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program⁹

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹⁰

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴
 5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²
 303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵
 115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁸
 103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶

Salinity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

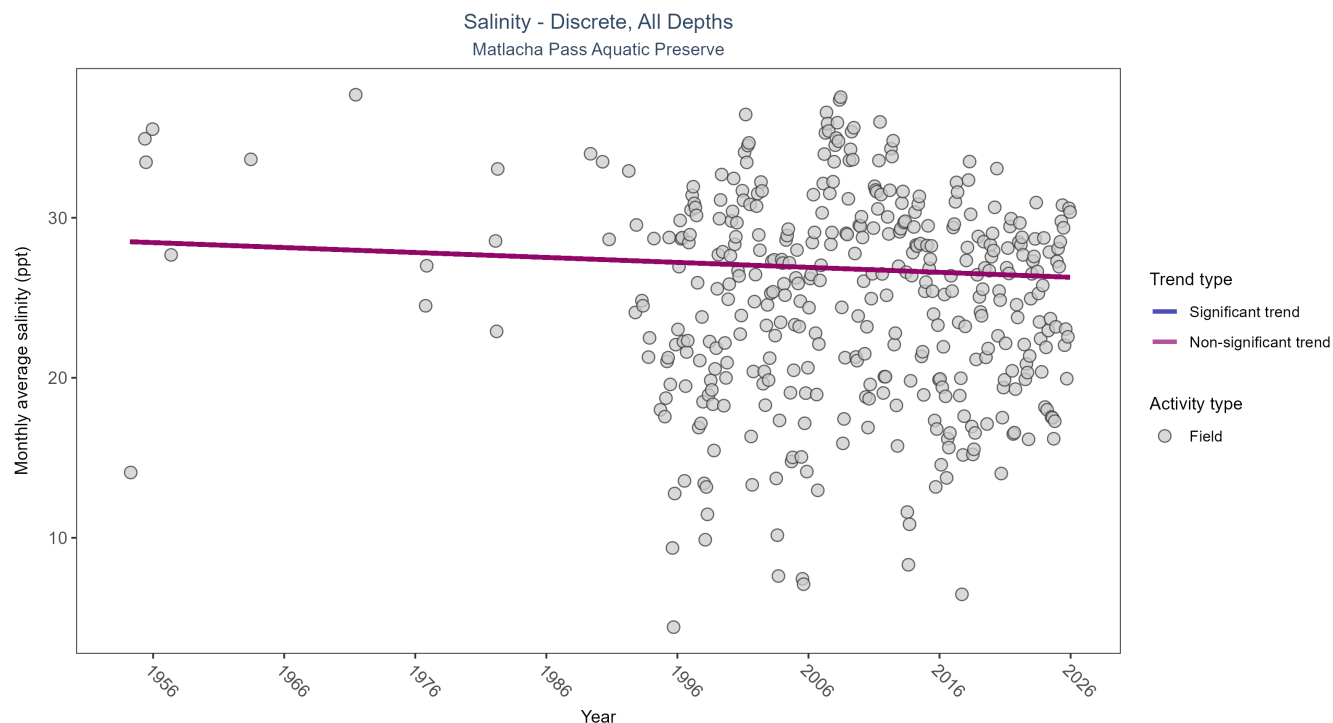


Figure 11: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines are also shown. Discrete salinity values derived from grab samples analyzed in the field (circles) or the laboratory (triangles) are both included in the plot.

Table 16: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Salinity

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
All	No detectable trend	11207	43	1954 - 2025	25.9	-0.0434	28.51	-0.0309	0.2072

Salinity showed no detectable trend between 1954 and 2025.

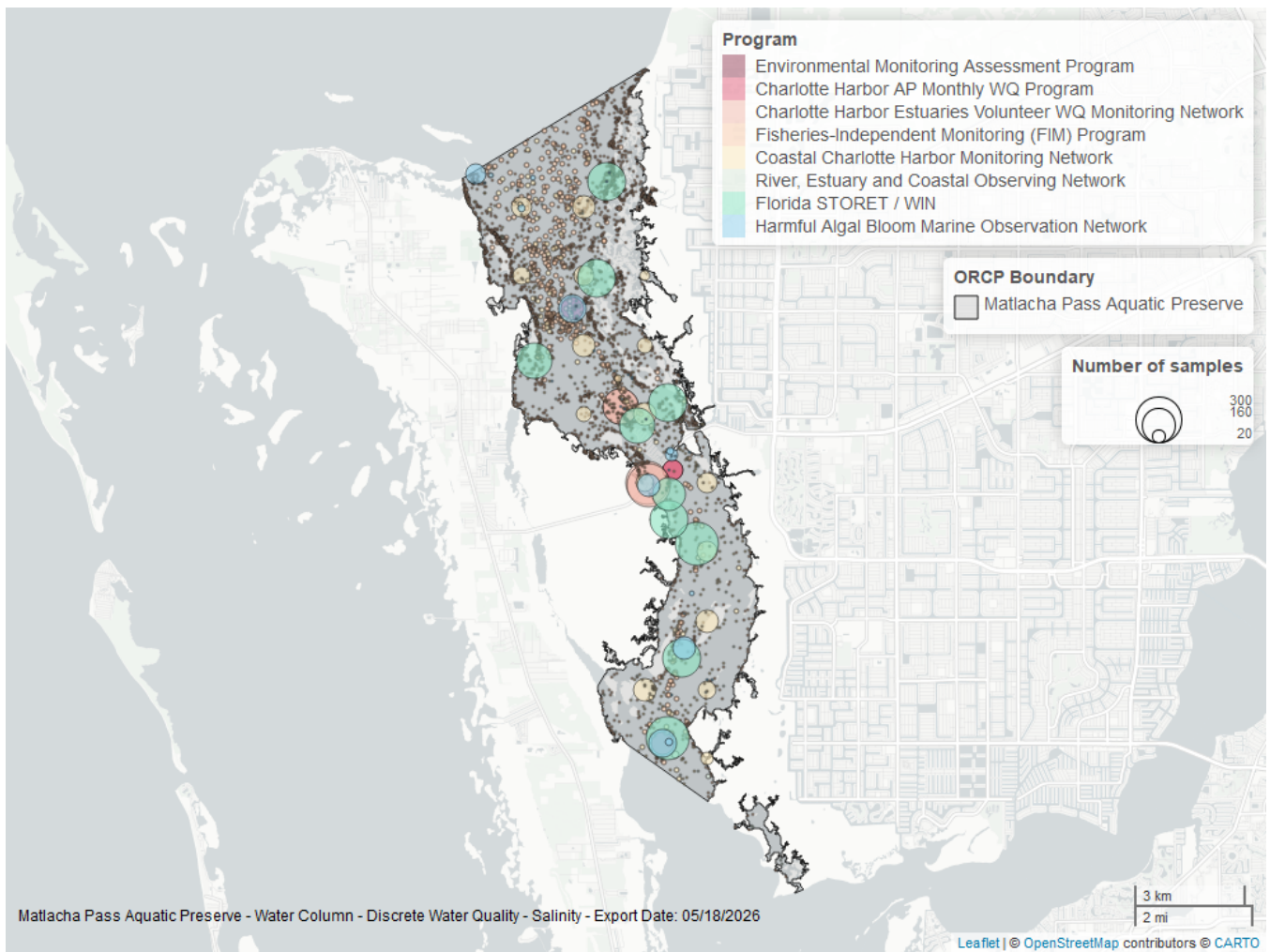


Figure 12: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 17: Programs contributing data for Salinity

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	5902	1989	2024
5002	2263	1995	2017
513	1687	2002	2025
95	559	1954	2018
476	487	1998	2025
5028	246	2007	2025
303	65	2018	2025
115	5	2001	2001

Program names:

69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program⁹

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹⁰

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²

303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵

115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁸

Total Nitrogen - Discrete

Total Nitrogen Calculation:

The logic for calculated Total Nitrogen was provided by Kevin O'Donnell and colleagues at FDEP (with the help of Jay Silvanima, Watershed Monitoring Section). The following logic is used, in this order, based on the availability of specific nitrogen components.

- 1) $TN = TKN + NO_3O_2$;
- 2) $TN = TKN + NO_3 + NO_2$;
- 3) $TN = ORGN + NH_4 + NO_3O_2$;
- 4) $TN = ORGN + NH_4 + NO_2 + NO_3$;
- 5) $TN = TKN + NO_3$;
- 6) $TN = ORGN + NH_4 + NO_3$;

Additional Information:

- Rules for use of sample fraction:
 - Florida Department of Environmental Protection (FDEP) report that if both “Total” and “Dissolved” components are reported, only “Total” is used. If the total is not reported, then the dissolved components are used as a best available replacement.
 - Total nitrogen calculations are done using nitrogen components with the same sample fraction, nitrogen components with mixed total/dissolved sample fractions are not used. In other words, total nitrogen can be calculated when TKN and NO₃O₂ are both total sample fractions, or when both are dissolved sample fractions. *Future calculations of total nitrogen values may be based on components with mixed sample fractions.*
- Values inserted into data:
 - ParameterName = “Total Nitrogen”
 - SEACAR_QAQCFlagCode = “1Q”
 - SEACAR_QAQC_Description = “SEACAR Calculated”

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

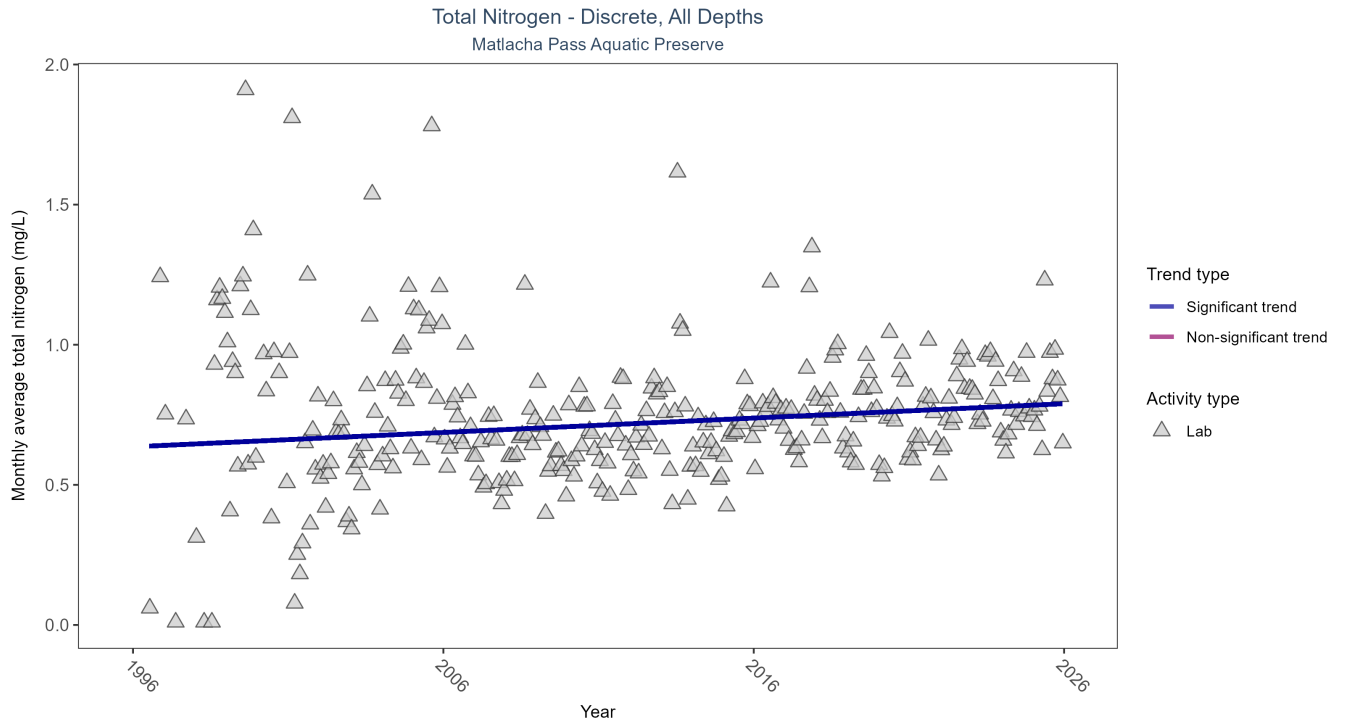


Figure 13: Scatter plot of monthly average total nitrogen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only nitrogen values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 18: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Nitrogen

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	Increasing trend	2139	30	1996 - 2025	0.71	0.1575	0.6356	0.0051	0

Monthly average total nitrogen increased by less than 0.01 mg/L per year.

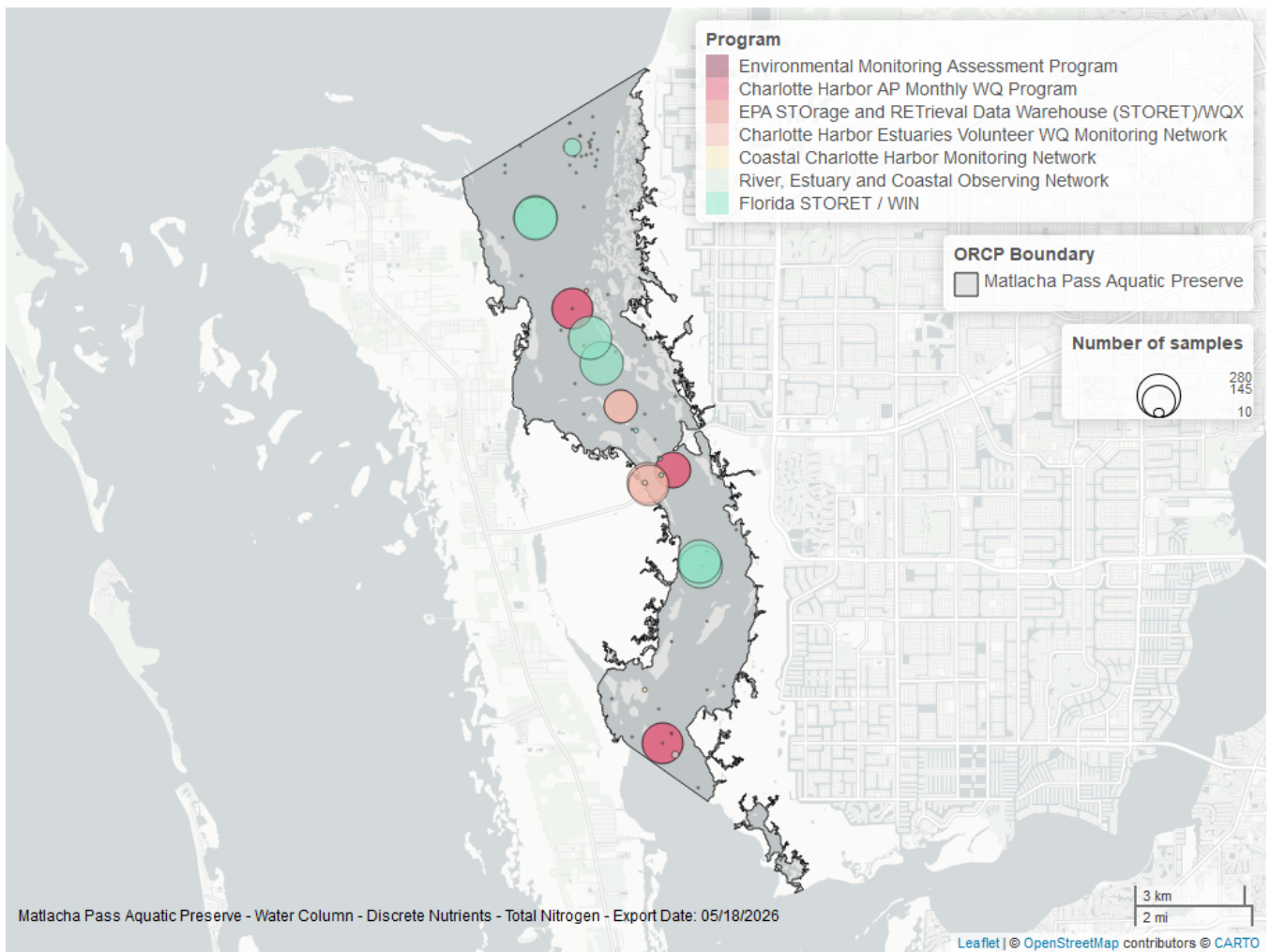


Figure 14: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 19: Programs contributing data for Total Nitrogen

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	903	1996	2025
5028	738	2005	2025
476	422	1998	2025
513	46	2009	2025
303	28	2018	2025
103	6	2001	2005
115	1	2001	2001

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵

Total Phosphorus - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

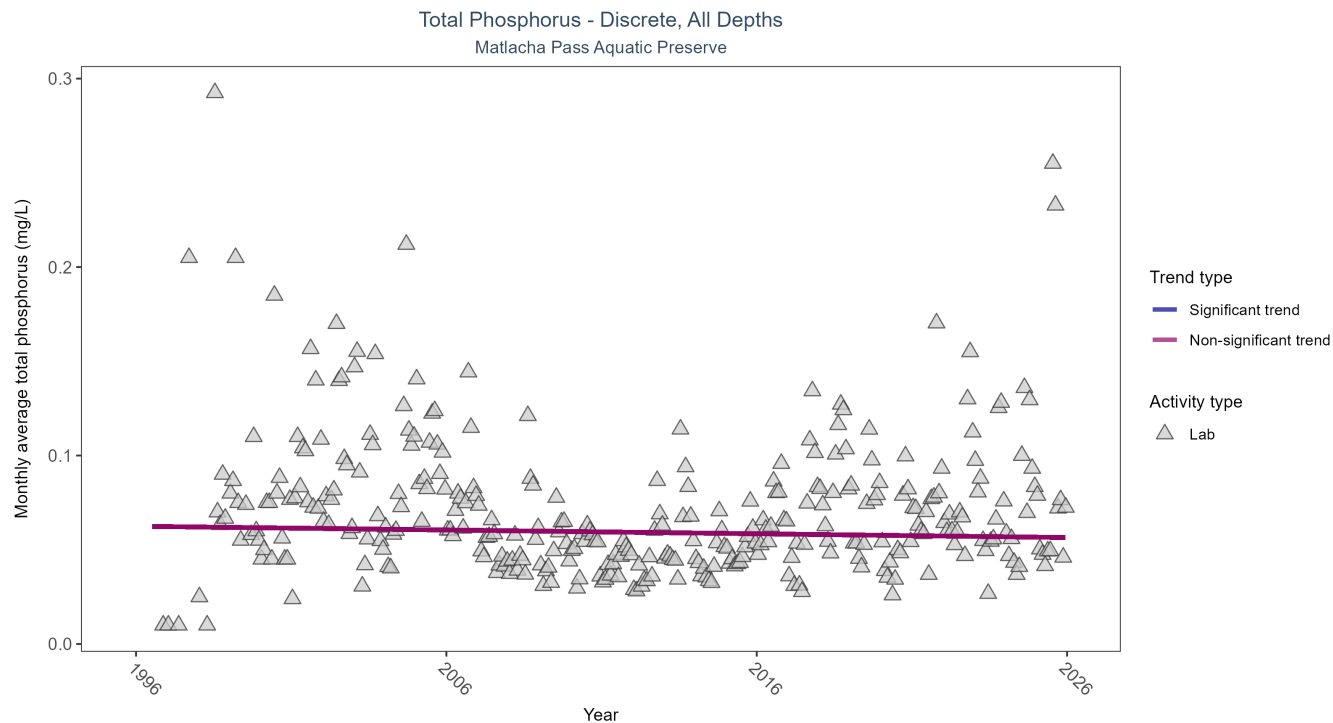


Figure 15: Scatter plot of monthly average total phosphorus over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only phosphorus values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 20: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Total Phosphorus

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	No detectable trend	2618	30	1996 - 2025	0.059	-0.0385	0.0625	-0.0002	0.3703

Total phosphorus showed no detectable trend between 1996 and 2025.

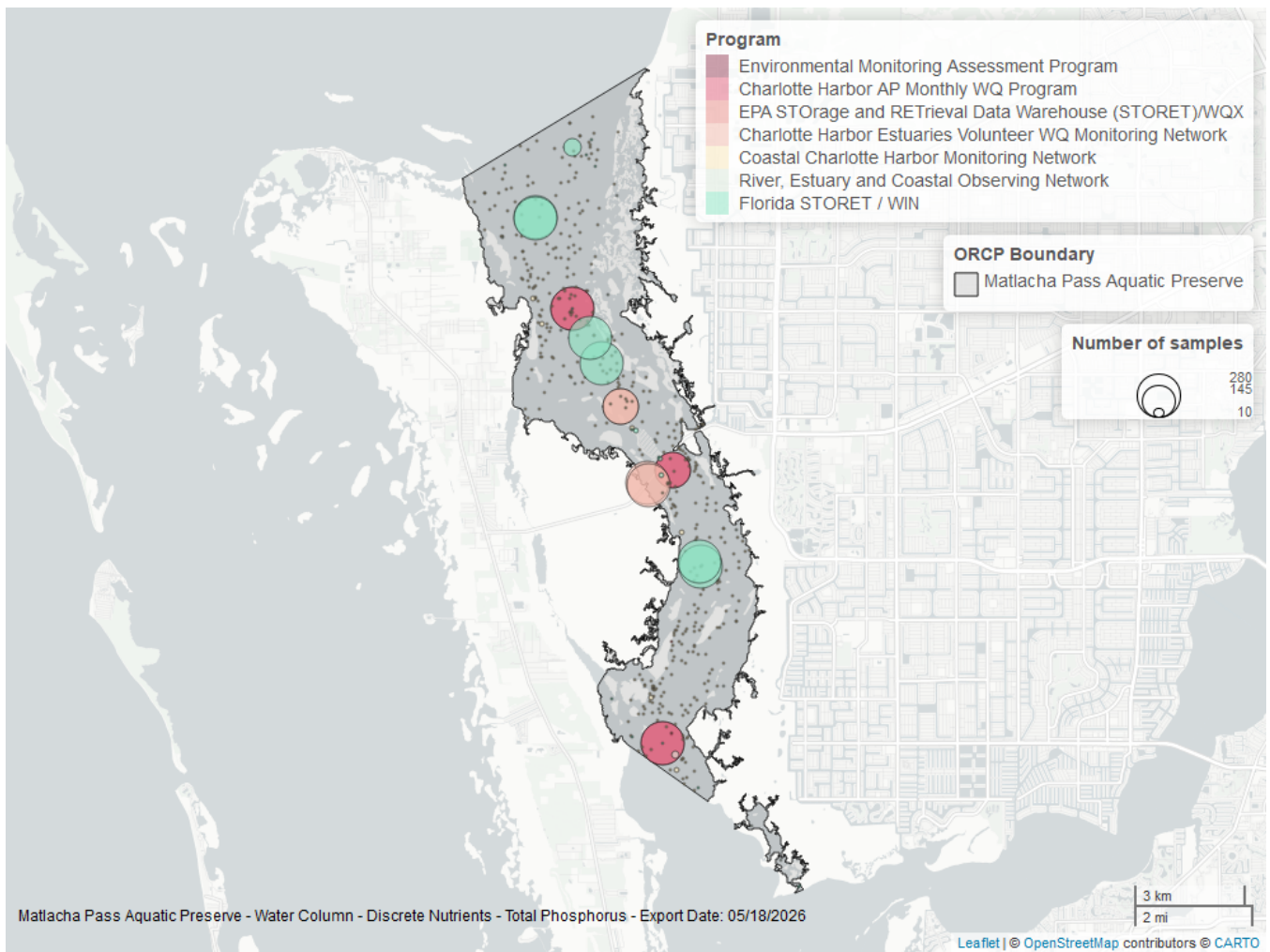


Figure 16: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 21: Programs contributing data for Total Phosphorus

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	906	1996	2025
5028	758	2005	2025
513	486	2017	2025
476	481	1998	2025
303	28	2018	2025
103	5	2001	2005
115	1	2001	2001

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵

Turbidity - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

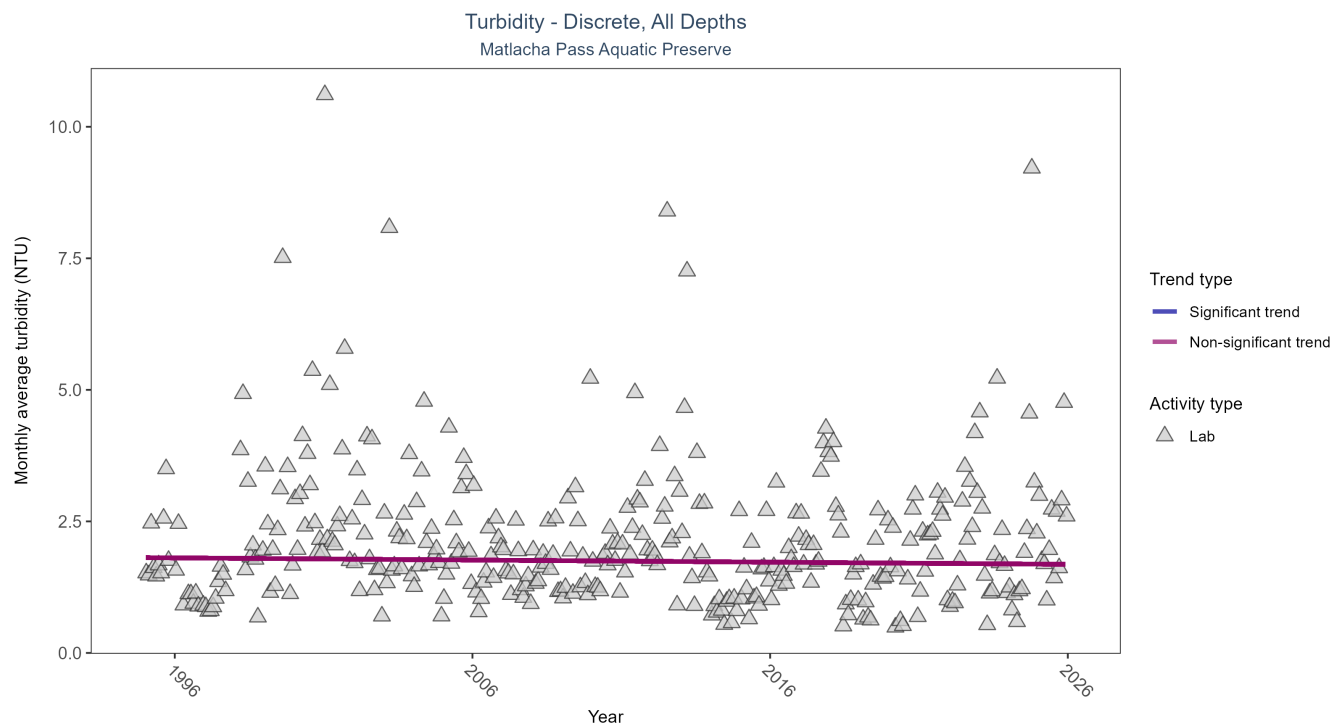


Figure 17: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only turbidity values measured in the laboratory (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 22: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Turbidity

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Lab	No detectable trend	3557	31	1995 - 2025	1.7	-0.0216	1.8108	-0.0041	0.4873

Turbidity showed no detectable trend between 1995 and 2025.

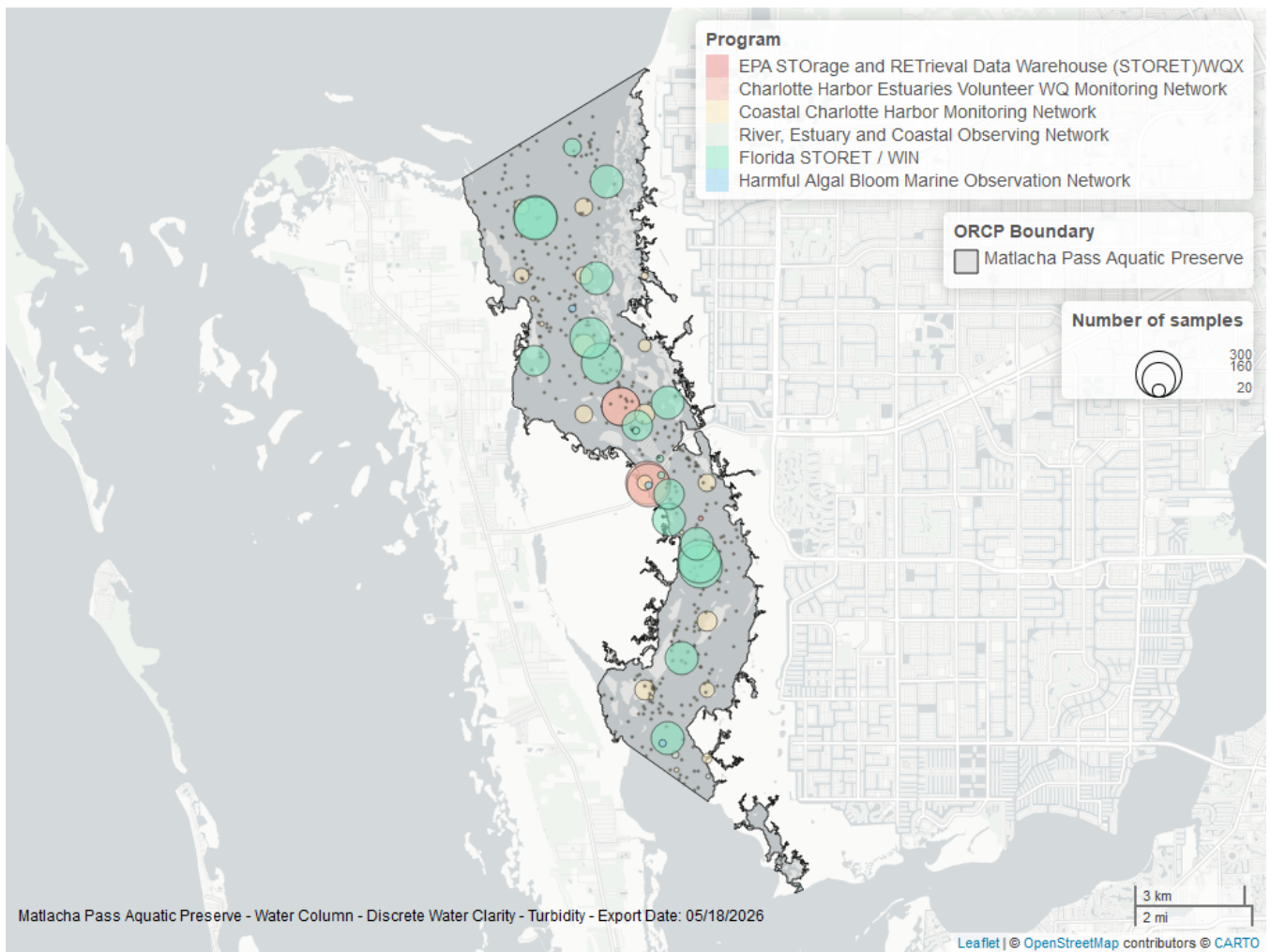


Figure 18: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 23: Programs contributing data for Turbidity

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
5002	2577	1995	2025
513	1127	2002	2025
476	493	1998	2025
303	65	2018	2025
95	31	2012	2013
103	5	2004	2005

Program names:

5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³

513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴

303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵

95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹⁰

103 - EPA STORage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶

Water Temperature - Discrete

Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis

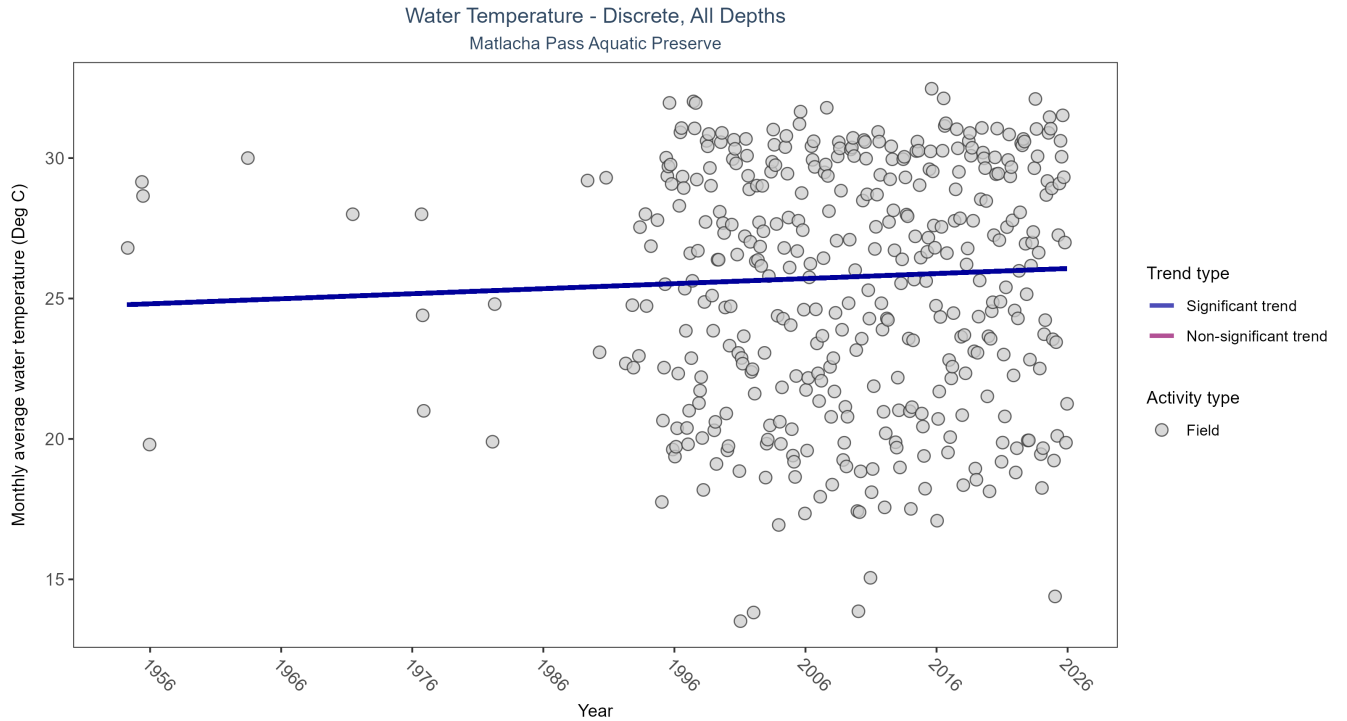


Figure 19: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only water temperature measurements taken in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 24: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Trend Analysis for Water Temperature

Activity Type	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
Field	Increasing trend	12120	42	1954 - 2025	26.2	0.0896	24.7753	0.018	0.0093

Monthly average water temperature increased by 0.02°C per year.

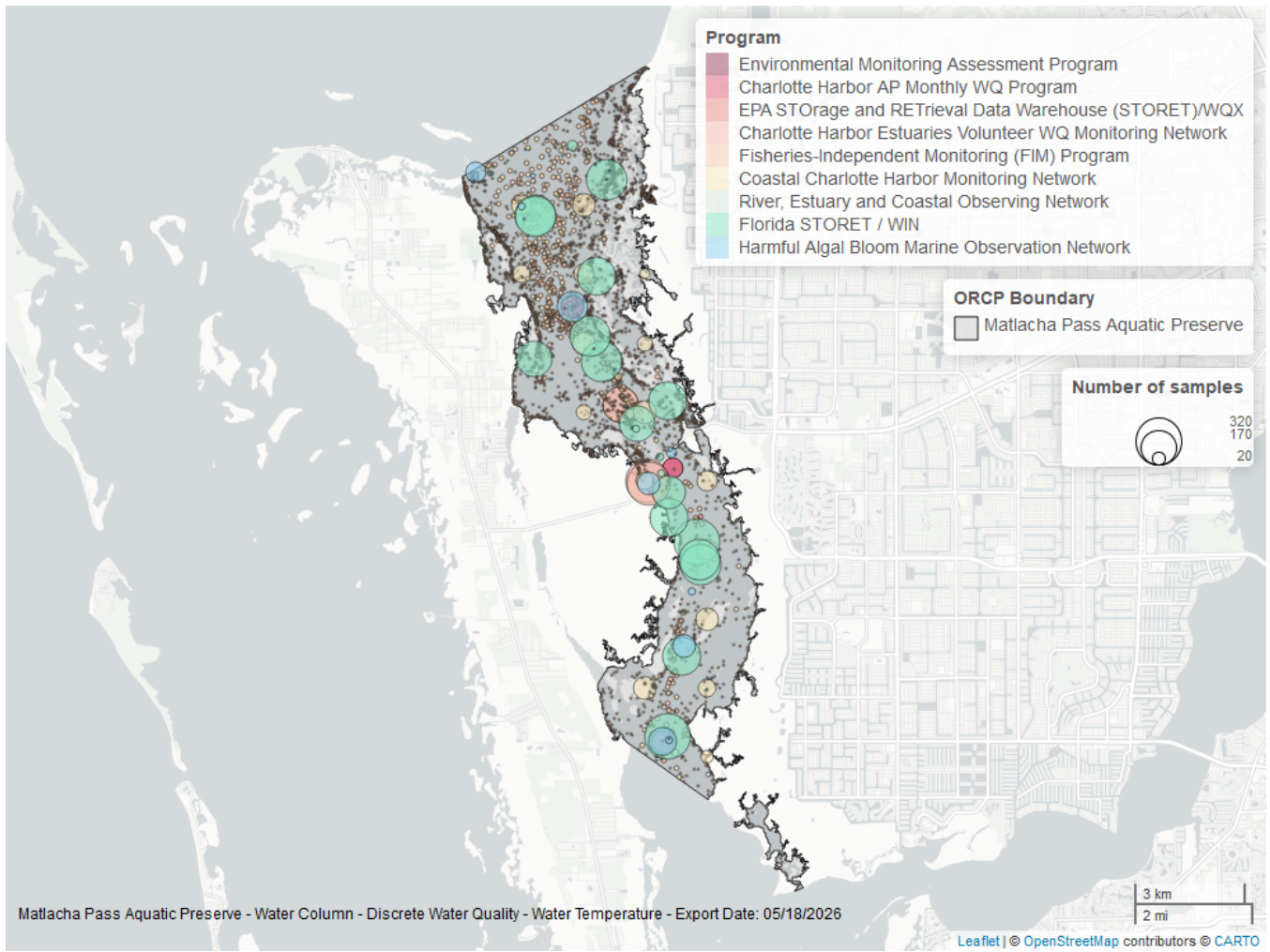


Figure 20: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Table 25: Programs contributing data for Water Temperature

ProgramID	N_Data	YearMin	YearMax
69	5906	1989	2024
5002	3155	1995	2025
513	1695	2002	2025
95	566	1954	2018
476	489	1998	2025
5028	236	2007	2025
303	65	2018	2025
103	6	2004	2005
115	5	2001	2001

Program names:

- 69 - Fisheries-Independent Monitoring (FIM) Program⁹
- 5002 - Florida STORET / WIN³
- 513 - Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network¹
- 95 - Harmful Algal Bloom Marine Observation Network¹⁰

476 - Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network⁴
5028 - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program²
303 - River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network⁵
103 - EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse (STORET)/WQX⁶
115 - Environmental Monitoring Assessment Program⁸

Water Quality - Continuous

The following files were used in the continuous analysis:

- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Chlorophyll_a_Uncorrected_for_Pheophytin-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Dissolved_Oxygen-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Dissolved_Oxygen_Saturation-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Fluorescent_Dissolved_Organic_Matter-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_pH-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Salinity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Specific_Conductivity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Turbidity-2026-Mar-06.txt*
- *Combined_WQ_WC_NUT_cont_Water_Temperature-2026-Mar-06.txt*

Continuous monitoring locations in Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve

Table 26: Station overview for Continuous parameters by Program

<i>ProgramID</i>	<i>ProgramLocationID</i>	<i>Years of Data</i>	<i>Use in Analysis</i>	<i>Parameters</i>
512	MP1A	21	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
512	MP2B	22	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity
512	MP3C	17	TRUE	pH , Dissolved Oxygen Saturation, Dissolved Oxygen , Turbidity , Water Temperature , Salinity , Specific Conductivity

Program names:

[512](#) - Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Continuous Water Quality Monitoring¹¹

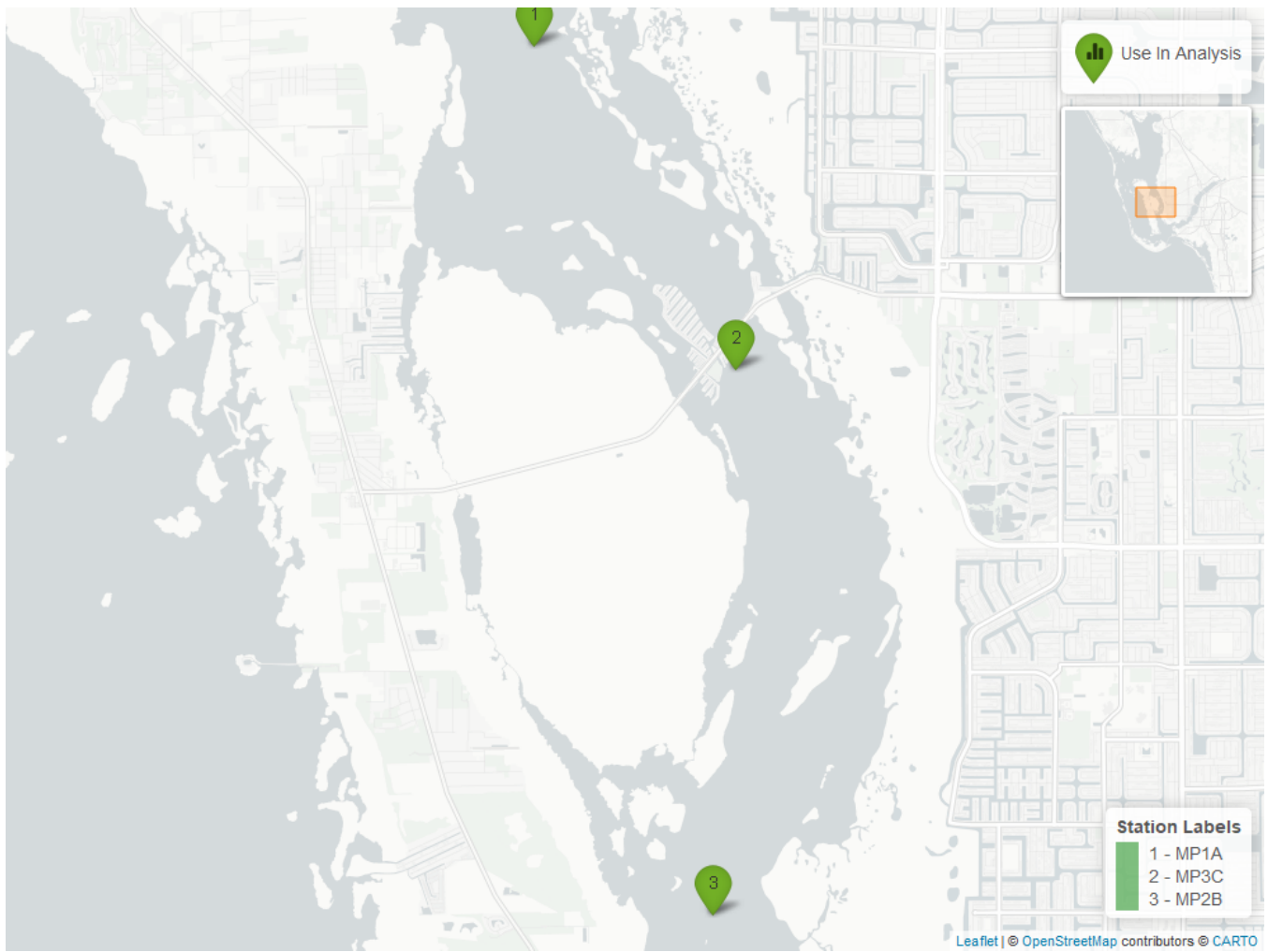


Figure 21: Map showing continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. Sites marked as *Use In Analysis* (green) are featured in this report.

pH - Continuous

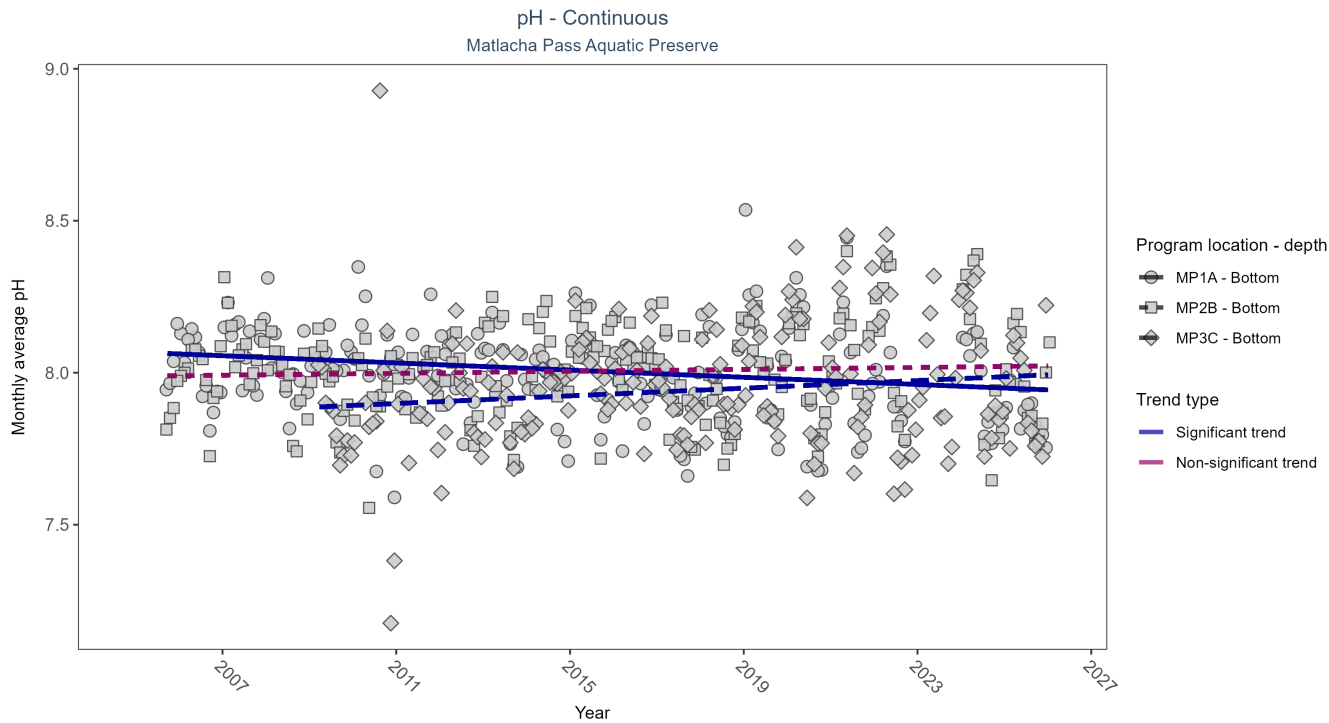


Figure 22: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 27: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for pH - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	Significantly decreasing trend	556253	20	2005 - 2025	8.0	-0.19	8.07	-0.01	0.00
MP2B	No significant trend	573184	21	2005 - 2026	8.0	0.04	7.99	0.00	0.39
MP3C	Significantly increasing trend	495721	17	2009 - 2025	7.9	0.13	7.89	0.01	0.02

At one program location, monthly average pH increased by 0.01 pH units per year. At one program location, monthly average pH decreased by 0.01 pH units per year. No detectable change in monthly average pH was observed at one location.

Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Continuous

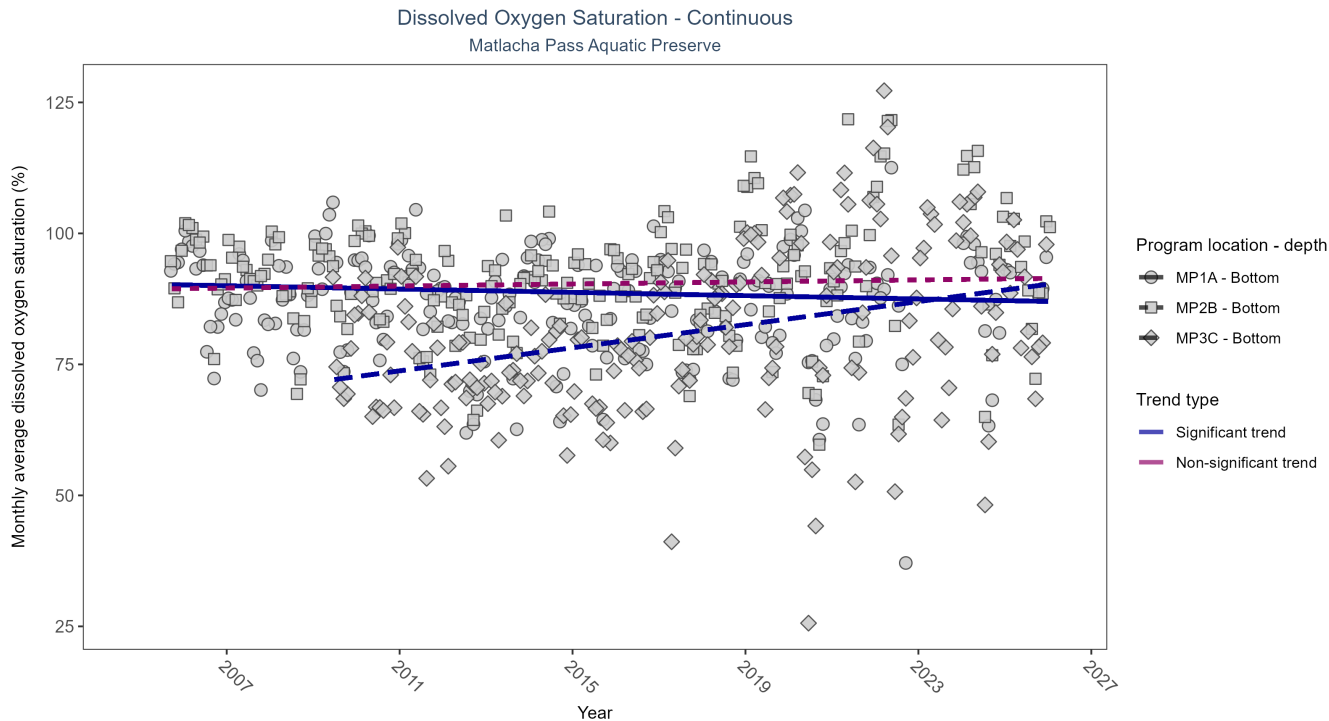


Figure 23: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 28: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	Significantly decreasing trend	561908	20	2005 - 2025	88.1	-0.11	90.32	-0.16	0.03
MP2B	No significant trend	593334	21	2005 - 2026	91.5	0.05	89.37	0.10	0.33
MP3C	Significantly increasing trend	514714	17	2009 - 2025	81.8	0.28	71.56	1.10	0.00

At one program location, monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation increased by 1.10% per year. At one program location, monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation decreased by 0.16% per year. No detectable change in monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation was observed at one location.

Dissolved Oxygen - Continuous

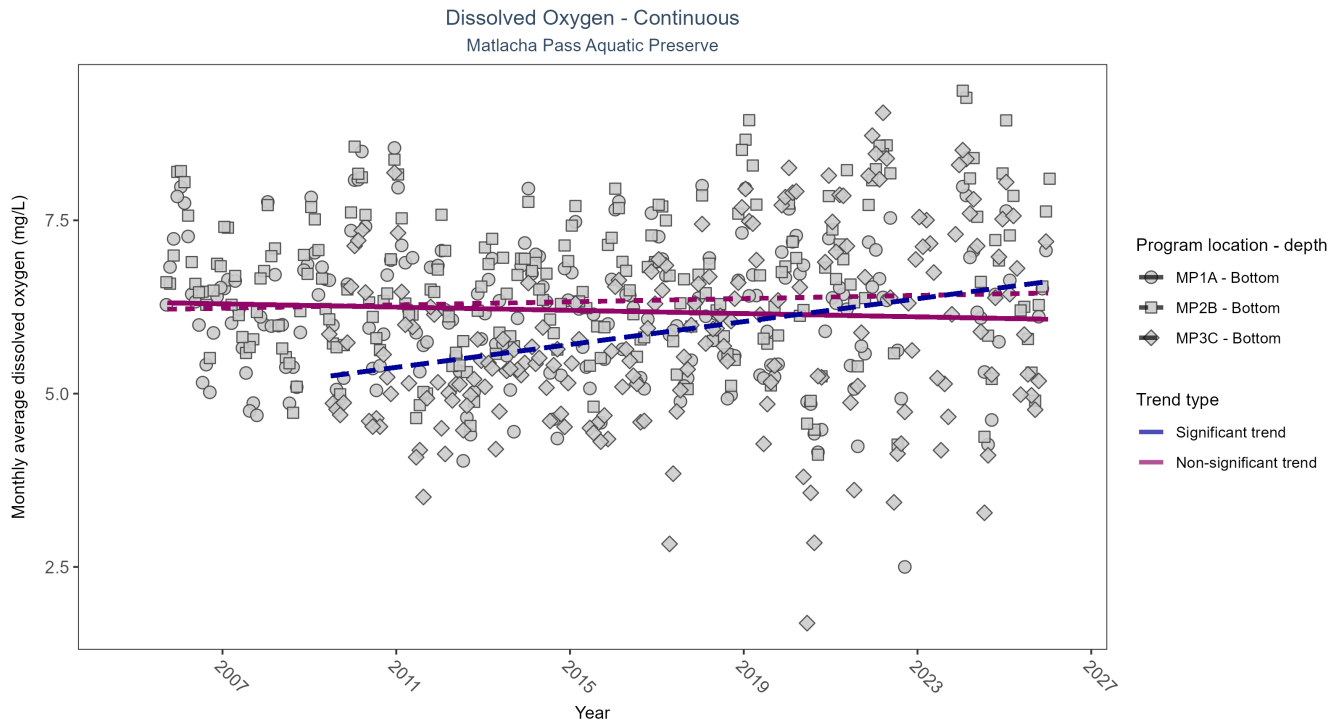


Figure 24: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 29: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Dissolved Oxygen - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	No significant trend	564550	20	2005 - 2025	6.3	-0.07	6.32	-0.01	0.17
MP2B	No significant trend	593033	21	2005 - 2026	6.7	0.08	6.21	0.01	0.10
MP3C	Significantly increasing trend	510586	17	2009 - 2025	5.9	0.28	5.21	0.08	0.00

At one program location, monthly average dissolved oxygen increased by 0.08 mg/L per year. No detectable change in monthly average dissolved oxygen was observed at two locations.

Turbidity - Continuous

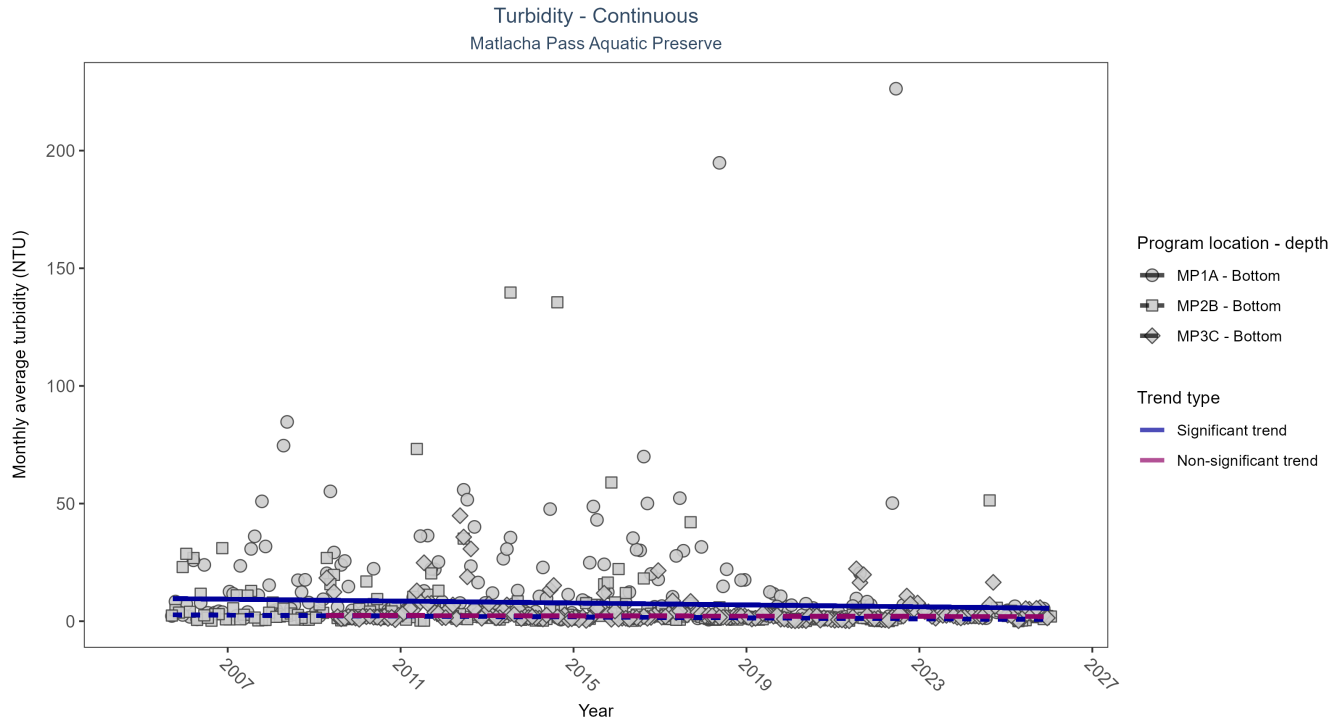


Figure 25: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 30: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Turbidity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	Significantly decreasing trend	478541	20	2005 - 2025	2	-0.19	9.76	-0.20	0.00
MP2B	Significantly decreasing trend	537901	21	2005 - 2026	1	-0.18	2.77	-0.10	0.00
MP3C	No significant trend	478258	17	2009 - 2025	2	-0.06	2.48	-0.03	0.25

At two program locations, monthly average turbidity decreased by 0.1 NTU per year at one site and by 0.2 NTU per year at the other. No detectable change in monthly average turbidity was observed at one location.

Water Temperature - Continuous

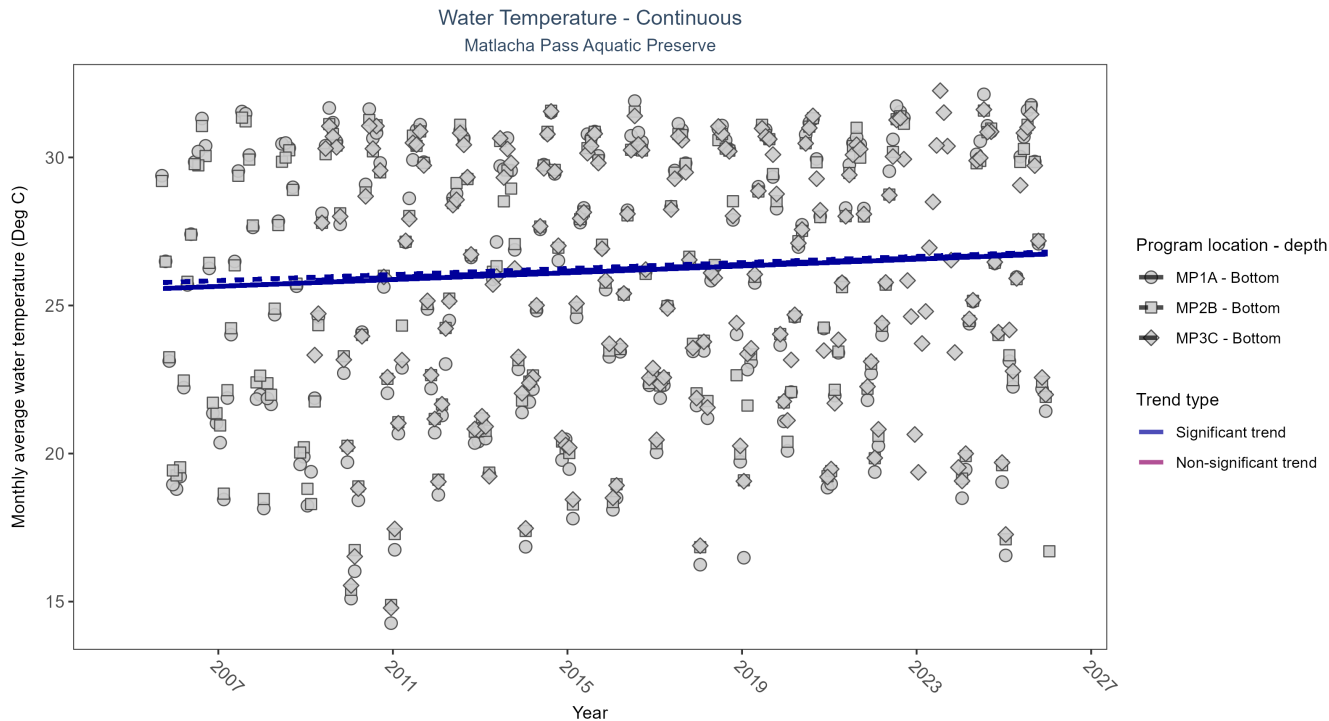


Figure 26: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 31: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Water Temperature - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	Significantly increasing trend	643697	20	2005 - 2025	26.4	0.25	25.53	0.06	0
MP2B	Significantly increasing trend	639164	21	2005 - 2026	26.2	0.21	25.74	0.05	0
MP3C	Significantly increasing trend	557705	17	2009 - 2025	26.6	0.20	25.84	0.05	0

At three program locations, monthly average water temperature increased between 0.05 and 0.06°C per year.

Salinity - Continuous

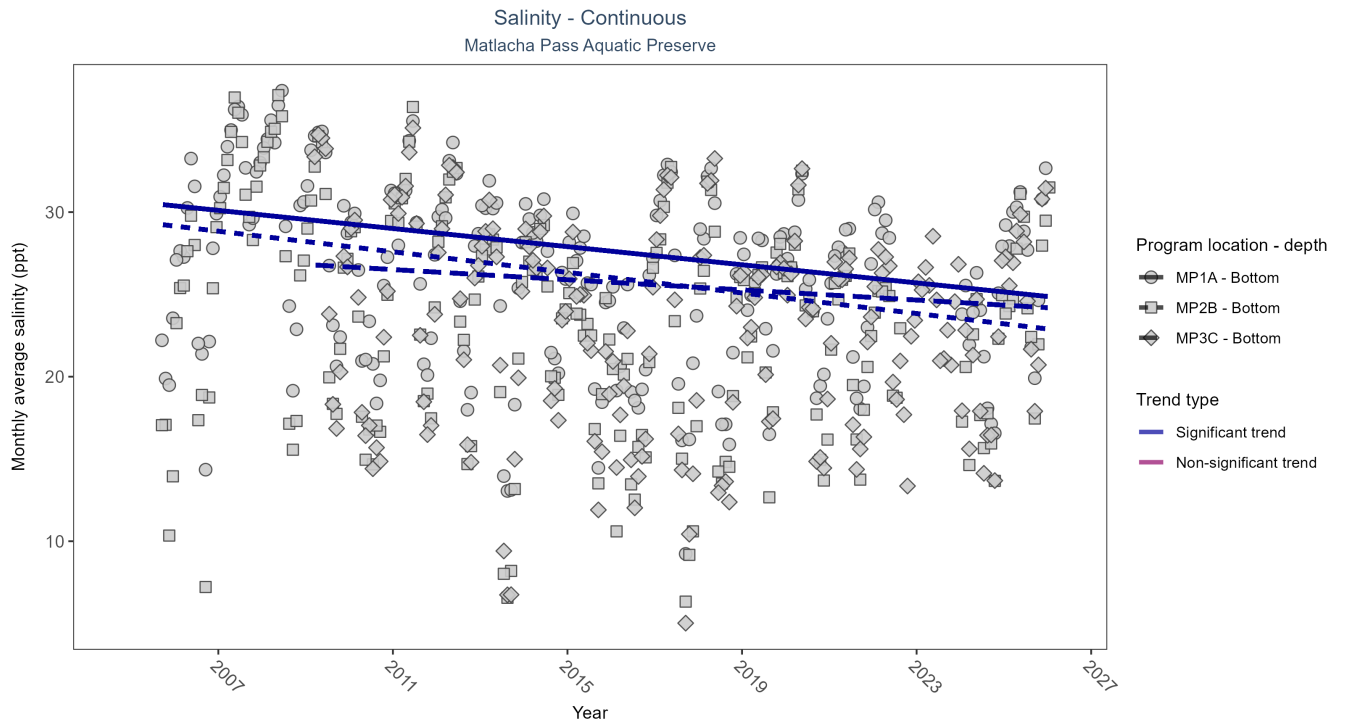


Figure 27: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 32: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Salinity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	Significantly decreasing trend	604162	20	2005 - 2025	27.1	-0.29	30.66	-0.28	0.00
MP2B	Significantly decreasing trend	625170	21	2005 - 2026	24.4	-0.27	29.46	-0.31	0.00
MP3C	Significantly decreasing trend	549532	17	2009 - 2025	23.7	-0.12	26.82	-0.15	0.02

At three program locations, monthly average salinity decreased between 0.15 and 0.31 ppt per year.

Specific Conductivity - Continuous

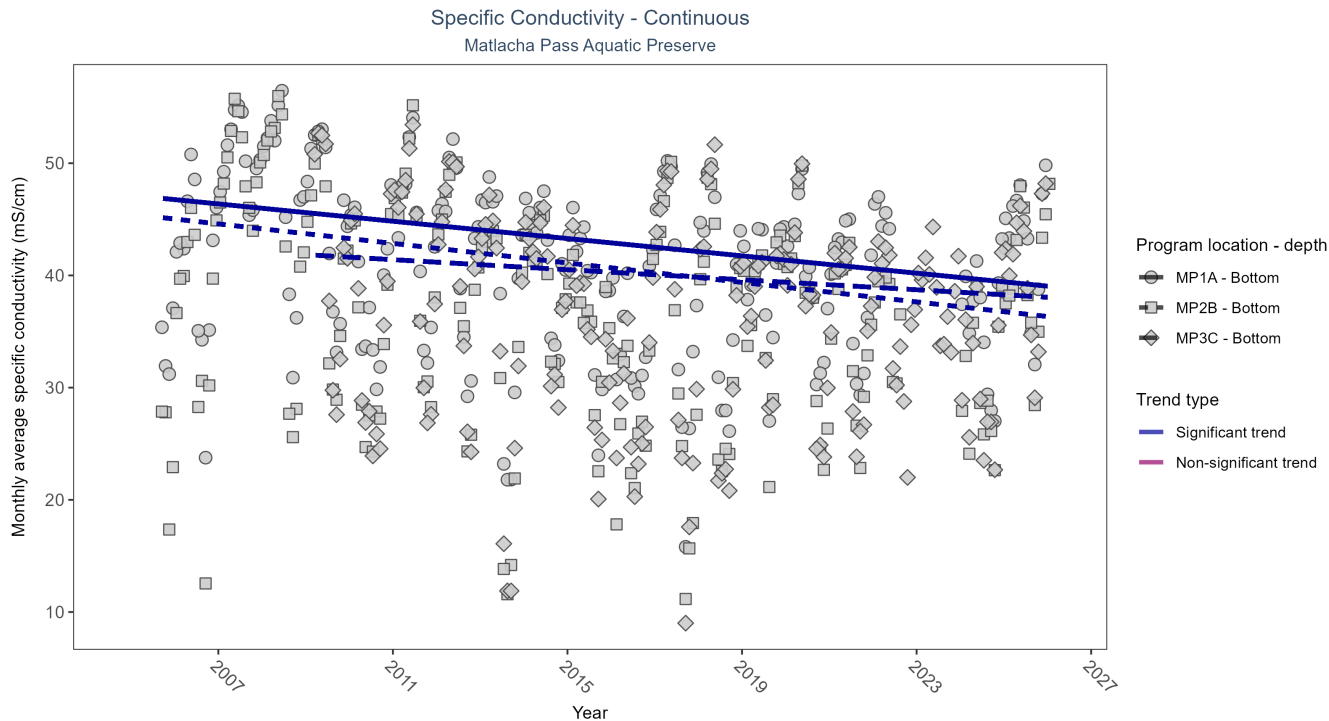


Figure 28: Scatter plot of monthly average specific conductivity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 33: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for Specific Conductivity - All Stations

Program Location	Statistical Trend	No. of Samples	No. Years with Data	Period of Record	Median Result Value	Tau	Sen Intercept	Sen Slope	P
MP1A	Significantly decreasing trend	601486	20	2005 - 2025	42.19	-0.29	47.14	-0.39	0.00
MP2B	Significantly decreasing trend	625170	21	2005 - 2026	38.39	-0.27	45.46	-0.43	0.00
MP3C	Significantly decreasing trend	548966	17	2009 - 2025	37.50	-0.12	41.85	-0.22	0.03

At three program locations, monthly average specific conductivity decreased between 0.22 and 0.43 mS/cm per year.

Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

The data file used is: **All_SAV_Parameters-2026-Jun-04.txt**

Submerged aquatic vegetation (SAV) refers to plants and plant-like macroalgae species that live entirely underwater. The two primary categories of SAV inhabiting Florida estuaries are *benthic macroalgae* and *seagrasses*. They often grow together in dense beds or meadows that carpet the seafloor. *Macroalgae* include multicellular species of green, red and brown algae that often live attached to the substrate by a holdfast. They tend to grow quickly and can tolerate relatively high nutrient levels, making them a threat to seagrasses and other benthic habitats in areas with poor water quality. In contrast, *seagrasses* are grass-like, vascular, flowering plants that are attached to the seafloor by extensive root systems. *Seagrasses* occur throughout the coastal areas of Florida, including protected bays and lagoons as well as deeper offshore waters on the continental shelf. *Seagrasses* have taken advantage of the broad, shallow shelf and clear water to produce two of the most extensive seagrass beds anywhere in continental North America.

Parameters

Percent Cover measures the fraction of an area of seafloor that is covered by SAV, usually estimated by evaluating multiple small areas of seafloor. Percent cover is often estimated for total SAV, individual types of vegetation (seagrass, attached algae, drift algae) and individual species.

Frequency of Occurrence was calculated as the number of times a taxon was observed in a year divided by the number of sampling events, multiplied by 100. Analysis is conducted at the quadrat level and is inclusive of all quadrats (i.e., quadrats evaluated using Braun-Blanquet, modified Braun-Blanquet, and percent cover.”

Species

Turtle grass (*Thalassia testudinum*) is the largest of the Florida seagrasses, with longer, thicker blades and deeper root structures than any of the other seagrasses. It is considered a climax seagrass species.

Shoal grass (*Halodule wrightii*) is an early colonizer of vegetated areas and usually grows in water too shallow for other species except *widgeon grass*. It can often tolerate larger salinity ranges than other seagrass species. *Shoal grass* is characterized by thin, flat blades, that are narrower than *turtle grass* blades.

Manatee grass (*Syringodium filiforme*) is easily recognizable because its leaves are thin and cylindrical instead of the flat, ribbon-like form shared by many other seagrass species. The leaves can grow up to half a meter in length. *Manatee grass* is usually found in mixed seagrass beds or small, dense monospecific patches.

Widgeon grass (*Ruppia maritima*) grows in both fresh and salt water and is widely distributed throughout Florida's estuaries in less saline areas, particularly in inlets along the east coast. This species resembles *shoal grass* in certain environments but can be identified by the pointed tips of its leaves.

Three species of *Halophila* spp. are found in Florida - **Star grass** (*Halophila engelmannii*), **Paddle grass** (*Halophila decipiens*), and **Johnson's seagrass** (*Halophila johnsonii*). These are smaller, more fragile seagrasses than other Florida species and are considered ephemeral. They grow along a single long rhizome, with short blades. These species are not well-studied, although surveys are underway to define their ecological roles.

Notes

Star grass, *Paddle grass*, and *Johnson's seagrass* will be grouped together and listed as **Halophila spp.** in the following managed areas. This is because several surveys did not specify to the species level:

- Banana River Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Malabar to Vero Beach Aquatic Preserve
- Indian River-Vero Beach to Ft. Pierce Aquatic Preserve
- Jensen Beach to Jupiter Inlet Aquatic Preserve
- Loxahatchee River-Lake Worth Creek Aquatic Preserve
- Mosquito Lagoon Aquatic Preserve

- Biscayne Bay Aquatic Preserve
- Florida Keys National Marine Sanctuary

Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve
SAV Percent Cover - Sample Locations



Figure 29: Maps showing the temporal scope of SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve* by program name.

Click [here](#) to view spatio-temporal plots on GitHub.

Sampling locations by Program:

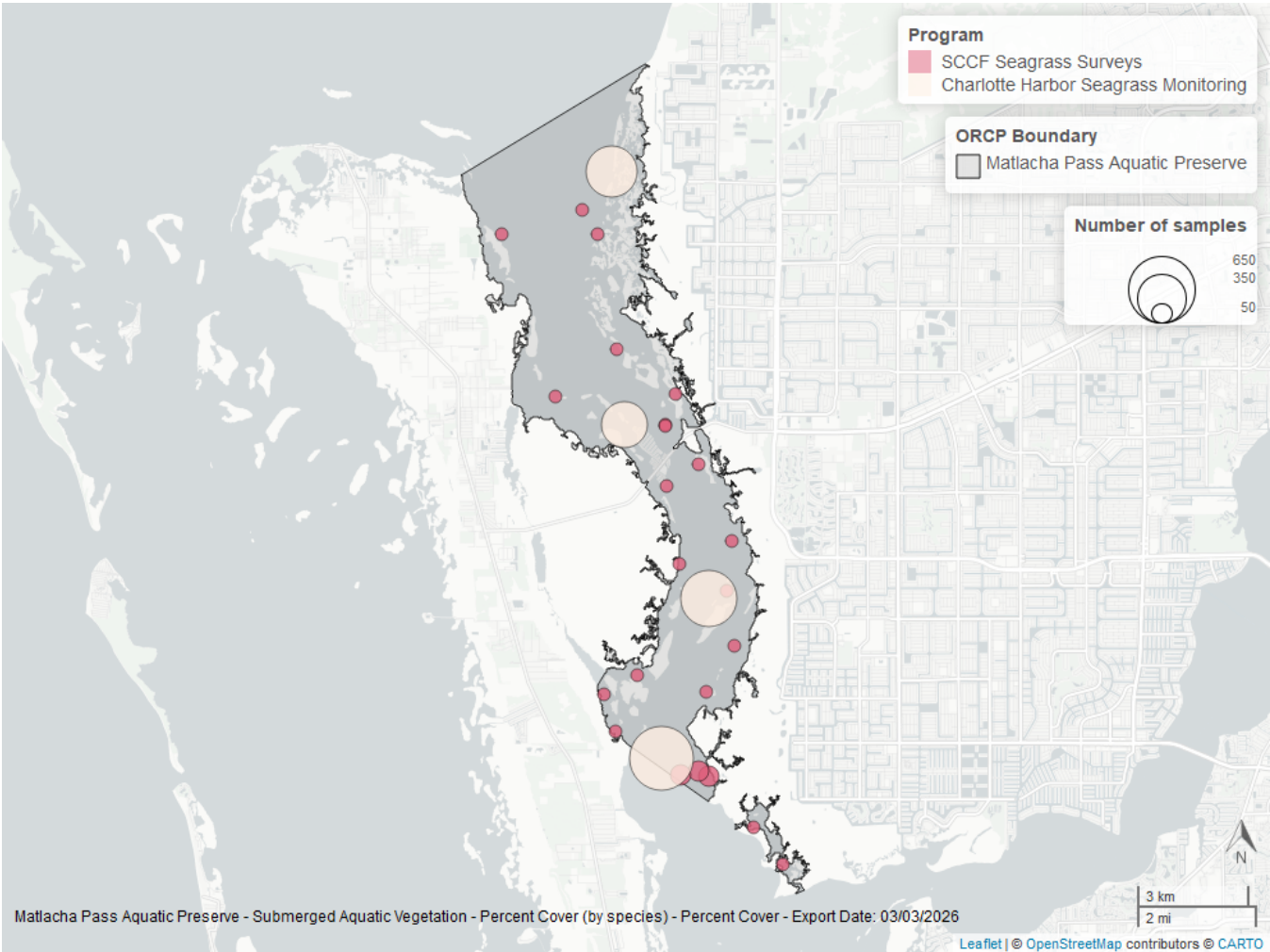


Figure 30: Map showing SAV sampling sites within the boundaries of *Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve*. The point size reflects the number of samples at a given sampling site.

Table 34: Program Information for Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

<i>ProgramID</i>	<i>N-Data</i>	<i>YearMin</i>	<i>YearMax</i>	<i>method</i>	<i>Sample Locations</i>
570	1835	2000	2024	Braun Blanquet	4
3015	776	2024	2024	Percent Occurrence	23

Program names:

570 - Charlotte Harbor Seagrass Monitoring¹²
3015 - SCCF Seagrass Surveys¹³

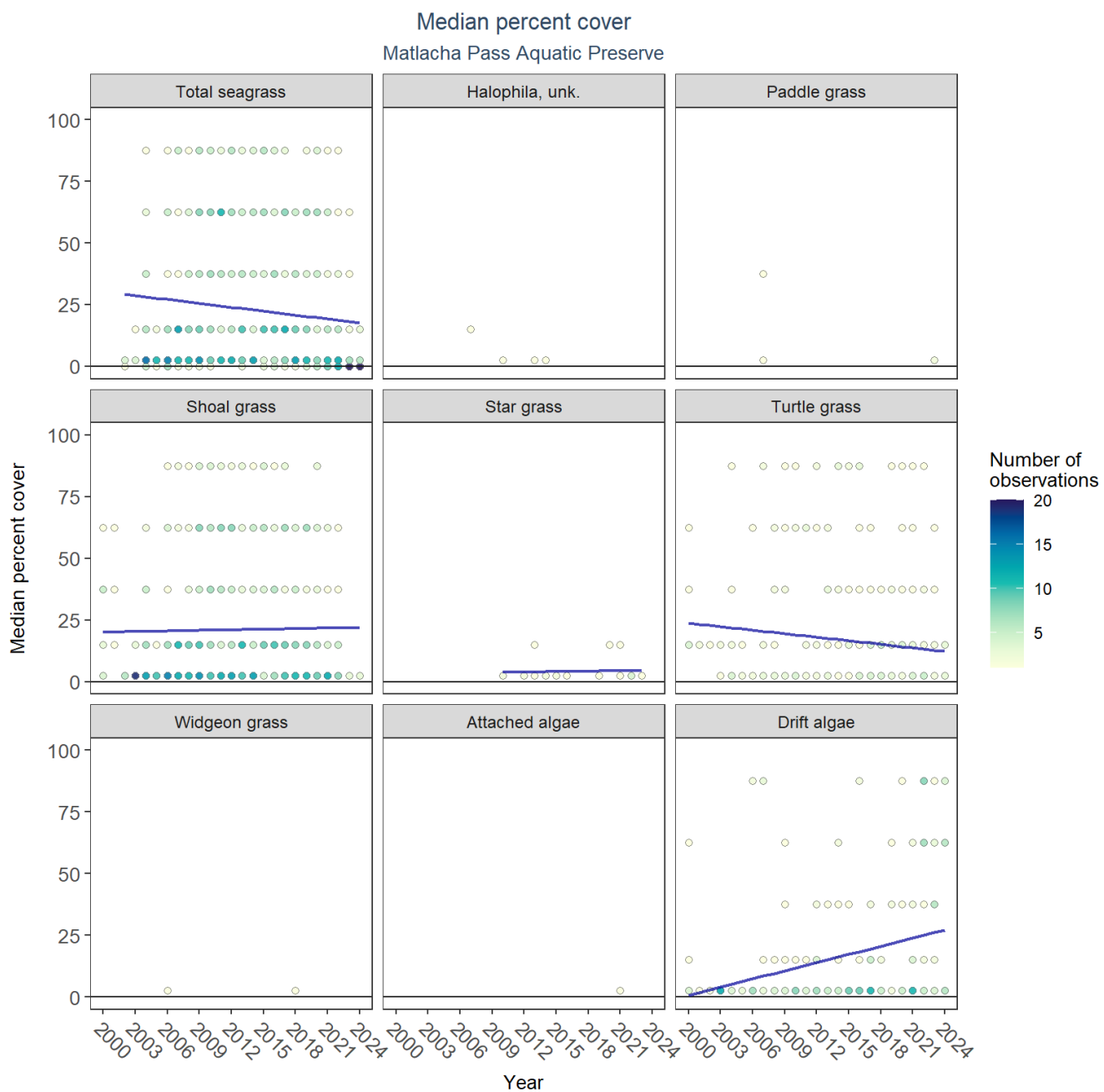


Figure 31: Scatter plots of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time by group. Plots for time series that included five or more years of observations show the estimated trend as a blue line.

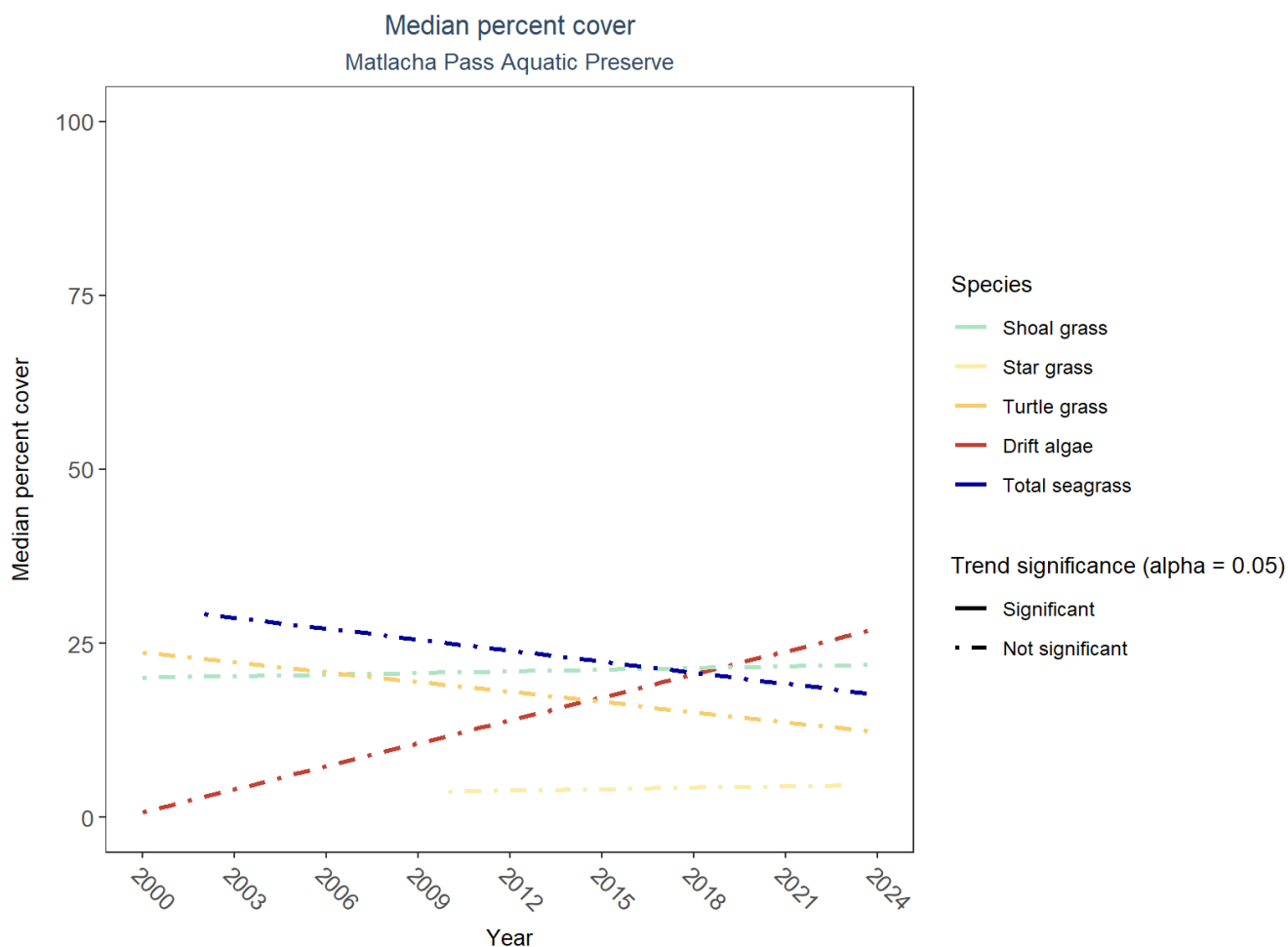


Figure 32: Trend lines of median percent cover of submerged aquatic vegetation over time for species that had five or more years of observations. Line type represents significance (solid) or non-significance (dashed) of the trends.

Table 35: Percent Cover Trend Analysis for Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve

<i>Species</i>	<i>Statistical Trend</i>	<i>Period of Record</i>	<i>LME Intercept</i>	<i>LME Slope</i>	<i>P</i>
Attached algae	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-
Drift algae	No detectable trend	2000 - 2024	-5.871223	1.1007911	0.1047490
Shoal grass	No detectable trend	2000 - 2024	19.631143	0.0765228	0.8805057
Paddle grass	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-
Star grass	No detectable trend	2010 - 2023	2.642281	0.0681648	0.7808875
Widgeon grass	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-
Turtle grass	No detectable trend	2000 - 2024	26.603566	-0.4765102	0.1583320
Total seagrass	No detectable trend	2002 - 2024	33.446649	-0.5262715	0.1342507
Halophila, unk.	Insufficient data	-	-	-	-

Total seagrass, shoal grass, star grass, turtle grass, and drift algae showed no detectable change in percent cover. Trends in percent cover could not be evaluated for unknown Halophila, paddle grass, widgeon grass, and attached algae due to insufficient data.

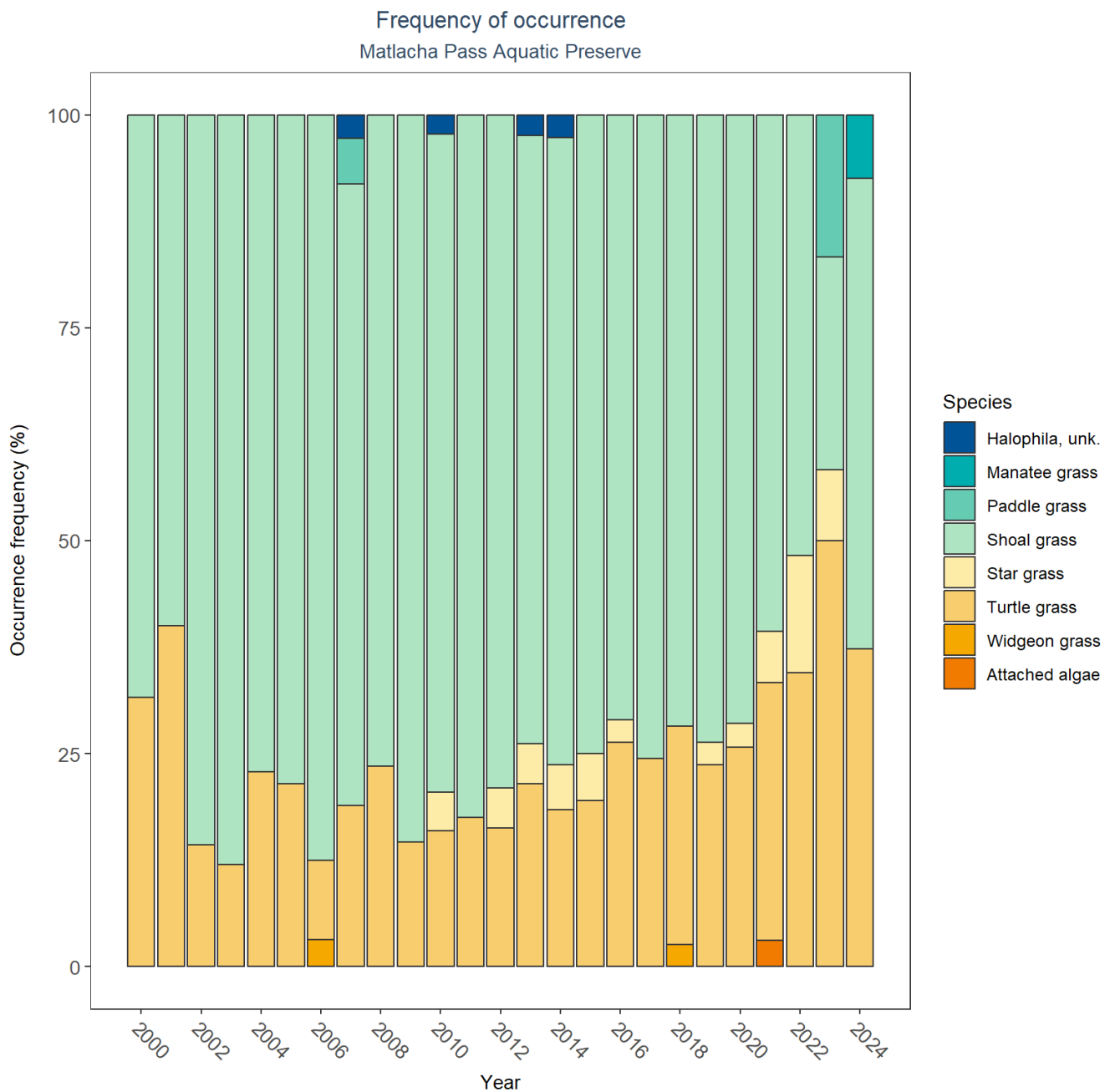


Figure 33: Bar plot of submerged aquatic vegetation species occurrence frequency over time by group.

SAV Water Column Analysis

The following parameters are available for Matlacha Pass Aquatic Preserve within the SAV_WC_Report:

- Chlorophyll a
- Dissolved Oxygen
- Dissolved Oxygen Saturation
- pH
- Salinity
- Secchi Depth

- Water Temperature
- Total Nitrogen
- Total Suspended Solids
- Turbidity

Access the reports here: [DRAFT_SAV_WC_Report.pdf](#)

Species list

Drift algae ¹	Halophila sp. ¹	Sargassum buxifolium ¹
Halodule wrightii ¹	Macroalgae ¹	Syringodium filiforme ¹
Halophila decipiens ¹	No grass in quadrat ¹	Thalassia testudinum ¹
Halophila engelmannii ¹	Ruppia maritima ¹	Total seagrass ¹

1 - Submerged Aquatic Vegetation

References

1. Charlotte Harbor National Estuary Program (CHNEP). [Coastal Charlotte Harbor Monitoring Network](#). (2024).
2. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP); Office of Resilience and Coastal Protection (RCP); Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves. [Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Monthly Water Quality Program](#). (2024).
3. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP). [Florida STORET / WIN](#). (2024).
4. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP); Office of Resilience and Coastal Protection (RCP); Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves. [Charlotte Harbor Estuaries Volunteer Water Quality Monitoring Network](#). (2024).
5. Sanibel-Captiva Conservation Foundation (SCCF). [River, Estuary and Coastal Observing Network](#). (2024).
6. U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). [EPA STOrage and RETrieval Data Warehouse \(STORET\)/WQX](#). (2023).
7. U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA); Office of Water; National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA); U.S. Geological Survey (USGS); U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS); National Estuary Program (NEP); coastal states. [National Aquatic Resource Surveys, National Coastal Condition Assessment](#). (2021).
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11. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP); Office of Resilience and Coastal Protection (RCP); Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves. [Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves Continuous Water Quality Monitoring](#). (2024).
12. Florida Department of Environmental Protection (DEP); Office of Resilience and Coastal Protection (RCP); Charlotte Harbor Aquatic Preserves. [Charlotte Harbor Seagrass Monitoring](#). (2023).
13. Sanibel-Captiva Conservation Foundation (SCCF). [SCCF Seagrass Surveys](#) . (2022).